Gameweek 11 Intelligence Report: Balanced Plus

FPL Intelligence | Balanced Plus (fourth strategy) squad, generated from the same FPL data snapshot and £100m budget as Balanced, Safe and Aggressive

Gameweek 11 | deadline Sat, 21 Nov 2026 11:00:00 GMT | generated 2026-11-12T20:33:06.502Z | optimisation mode: balanced-plus

Data: FPL API fetched 2026-11-12T20:33:06.297Z (source: live).

FACT = real FPL data (price, ownership, status, season stats, fixtures, FDR). MODEL = this app's prediction (xPts, confidence, start probability, expected minutes, breakdown, recommendations). Predictions are estimates, not guarantees.

Squad summary

Formation	Captain (x2)	Vice-captain	Projected points	Squad cost	Remaining	Model confidence
3-4-3	Haaland	Isak	55.5 xPts	£99.9m	£0.1m	83% overall (XI 83%); 15 high / 0 medium / 0 low

Sum of starting XI expected points plus captain's extra points (captain x2; Bench Boost counts all 15; Triple Captain x3).

How to use this report for an independent review

This PDF contains selectable text and a complete machine-readable JSON copy (final pages, and attached to the PDF as a file). Upload it to an AI assistant and ask, for example:

"You are an experienced FPL manager. Using only this report, review the squad, starting XI, captain, bench order and any transfer or chip advice for this gameweek. Point out risks, anything the model may have missed, and what you would change and why. Do not invent statistics that are not in the report."

- Check the captain/vice choice against fixtures and minutes security.
- Check each starter's start probability and any warnings, especially flagged players.
- Sanity-check xPts breakdowns (appearance, goals, assists, clean sheet, bonus) for implausible values.
- Challenge the transfer decision (save vs move vs hit) and the chip verdicts using the next-five-gameweek fixtures.
- Look for club-concentration, bench-quality and budget-use issues.

Starting XI (3-4-3) - 11 players

#	Pos	Player	Club	£m	Own	xPts	Confidence	Start	xMin	GW fixture(s)	Mins	G/A	xG/xA	Form	Status
1	GKP	Trafford	LEE	5.0	6.5%	3.87	high (85)	100%	80	CHE(A) FDR4	900	0/0	0/0.02	6	fit
2	DEF	Van Hecke	TOT	5.1	14.6%	4.92	high (85)	100%	80	IPS(H) FDR2	900	2/0	1.7/0.72	7.5	fit
3	DEF	De Cuyper	BHA	5.5	47.8%	4.10	high (82)	97%	78	HUL(A) FDR2	822	2/4	2.44/1.46	5.5	fit
4	DEF	Vuskovic	BHA	5.3	9.3%	4.12	high (84)	100%	80	HUL(A) FDR2	887	1/2	1.25/0.22	7.5	fit
5	MID	Tavernier	BOU	6.7	31.4%	4.92	high (82)	98%	79	NFO(H) FDR3	840	5/0	4.21/1.45	6.5	fit
6	MID	Mbeumo	MUN	7.9	19.1%	3.78	high (85)	100%	80	LIV(A) FDR4	892	4/1	4.63/1.29	3.2	fit
7	MID	E.Le Fée	SUN	5.7	2.8%	4.40	high (83)	99%	79	AVL(A) FDR3	863	3/1	3.83/1.86	6.5	fit
8	MID	Ødegaard	ARS	6.7	16.5%	4.25	high (82)	97%	78	NEW(A) FDR3	823	3/0	2.4/2.48	5	fit
9	FWD	Haaland (C)	MCI	15.8	78.9%	5.52	high (85)	100%	80	FUL(H) FDR2	889	9/0	7.06/0.87	6.2	fit
10	FWD	Barry	EVE	5.7	10.7%	4.65	high (83)	98%	79	BRE(A) FDR4	851	6/1	7.29/0.48	7.2	fit
11	FWD	Isak (V)	LIV	9.3	25.1%	5.50	high (76)	88%	72	MUN(H) FDR3	747	7/0	4.88/0.28	7	fit

Bench (in substitution order)

#	Pos	Player	Club	£m	Own	xPts	Confidence	Start	xMin	GW fixture(s)	Mins	G/A	xG/xA	Form	Status
B1	GKP	Tzolakis	HUL	4.7	13.5%	3.58	high (85)	100%	80	BHA(H) FDR4	900	0/0	0/0	3.2	fit
B2	MID	Groß	BHA	6.3	48.1%	4.15	high (84)	99%	80	HUL(A) FDR2	880	4/6	3.03/2.22	4.2	fit
B3	DEF	Muharemović	LEE	5.1	6.4%	3.80	high (85)	100%	80	CHE(A) FDR4	900	0/2	0.65/0.24	6.8	fit
B4	DEF	Silva	BOU	5.1	3.7%	4.28	high (85)	100%	80	NFO(H) FDR3	900	0/0	1.3/0.37	6.8	fit

Season columns (Mins, G/A, xG/xA, Form, Status, Own, price) are FACT from FPL. xPts, Confidence, Start, xMin are MODEL predictions for this gameweek.

Expected-points breakdown (MODEL)

Player	Role	Appear.	Goals	Assists	Clean sheet	Goals conc.	Saves	Def. contrib.	Bonus	Cards	Form tilt	Total xPts
Trafford	XI	1.93	0	0.01	0.85	-0.47	0.81	0	0.73	-0.01	0.03	3.87
Van Hecke	XI	1.93	1.03	0.22	1.14	-0.34	0	0.53	0.50	-0.18	0.11	4.92
De Cuyper	XI	1.90	0.84	0.36	1.04	-0.36	0	0.06	0.58	-0.25	-0.08	4.10
Vuskovic	XI	1.92	0.46	0.14	1.06	-0.37	0	0.62	0.34	-0.07	0.02	4.12
Tavernier	XI	1.91	1.62	0.34	0.28	0	0	0.22	0.83	-0.32	0.04	4.92
Mbeumo	XI	1.93	1.30	0.28	0.16	0	0	0.02	0.35	-0.19	-0.06	3.78
E.Le Fée	XI	1.92	1.37	0.43	0.18	0	0	0.08	0.39	-0.07	0.10	4.40
Ødegaard	XI	1.90	1.03	0.49	0.29	0	0	0.03	0.64	-0.13	0	4.25
Haaland	XI	1.93	2.43	0.21	0	0	0	0	1.06	-0.07	-0.04	5.52
Barry	XI	1.91	1.93	0.16	0	0	0	0	0.64	-0.07	0.08	4.65
Isak	XI	1.79	2.33	0.15	0	0	0	0	1.33	-0.13	0.01	5.50
Tzolakis	bench 1	1.93	0	0	0.85	-0.47	0.93	0	0.48	-0.07	-0.08	3.58
Groß	bench 2	1.92	1.05	0.56	0.26	0	0	0.07	0.70	-0.31	-0.11	4.15
Muharemović	bench 3	1.93	0.28	0.16	0.85	-0.47	0	0.88	0.24	-0.12	0.05	3.80
Silva	bench 4	1.93	0.48	0.11	1.15	-0.33	0	0.81	0.24	-0.30	0.20	4.28

Fixtures and expected points: next five gameweeks

Player	GW11 fixture, xPts	GW12 fixture, xPts	GW13 fixture, xPts	GW14 fixture, xPts	GW15 fixture, xPts
Trafford	CHE(A) FDR4, 3.9	COV(H) FDR2, 4.4	MCI(A) FDR5, 3.8	IPS(H) FDR2, 4.3	LIV(A) FDR4, 3.8
Van Hecke	IPS(H) FDR2, 4.9	SUN(A) FDR3, 4.2	FUL(H) FDR2, 4.6	ARS(H) FDR4, 4.1	HUL(A) FDR2, 4.1
De Cuyper	HUL(A) FDR2, 4.1	NEW(H) FDR3, 4.9	BOU(A) FDR4, 3.8	NFO(A) FDR2, 3.9	EVE(H) FDR3, 4.6
Vuskovic	HUL(A) FDR2, 4.1	NEW(H) FDR3, 4.7	BOU(A) FDR4, 3.8	NFO(A) FDR2, 4.0	EVE(H) FDR3, 4.5
Tavernier	NFO(H) FDR3, 4.9	FUL(A) FDR3, 4.5	BHA(H) FDR4, 4.7	HUL(H) FDR2, 5.0	ARS(A) FDR5, 3.9
Mbeumo	LIV(A) FDR4, 3.8	BRE(H) FDR3, 4.3	NEW(A) FDR3, 4.2	COV(H) FDR2, 4.8	CRY(A) FDR2, 4.8
E.Le Fée	AVL(A) FDR3, 4.4	TOT(H) FDR3, 4.5	LIV(A) FDR4, 4.0	NEW(A) FDR3, 4.4	NFO(H) FDR3, 4.5
Ødegaard	NEW(A) FDR3, 4.3	MCI(H) FDR4, 4.4	BRE(A) FDR4, 4.0	TOT(A) FDR3, 3.9	BOU(H) FDR3, 4.4
Haaland	FUL(H) FDR2, 5.5	ARS(A) FDR5, 4.2	LEE(H) FDR3, 5.2	BRE(A) FDR4, 4.9	CHE(H) FDR4, 5.9
Barry	BRE(A) FDR4, 4.7	LIV(H) FDR4, 5.0	AVL(A) FDR3, 5.1	FUL(H) FDR2, 5.2	BHA(A) FDR4, 4.4
Isak	MUN(H) FDR3, 5.5	EVE(A) FDR3, 4.3	SUN(H) FDR2, 5.3	CHE(A) FDR4, 4.7	LEE(H) FDR3, 4.6
Tzolakis	BHA(H) FDR4, 3.6	CRY(A) FDR2, 3.6	NFO(H) FDR3, 3.8	BOU(A) FDR4, 3.4	TOT(H) FDR3, 3.8
Groß	HUL(A) FDR2, 4.2	NEW(H) FDR3, 5.0	BOU(A) FDR4, 4.1	NFO(A) FDR2, 4.1	EVE(H) FDR3, 4.5
Muharemović	CHE(A) FDR4, 3.8	COV(H) FDR2, 4.7	MCI(A) FDR5, 3.6	IPS(H) FDR2, 4.5	LIV(A) FDR4, 3.8
Silva	NFO(H) FDR3, 4.3	FUL(A) FDR3, 3.8	BHA(H) FDR4, 3.8	HUL(H) FDR2, 4.4	ARS(A) FDR5, 3.4

Why each player is in the squad, and warnings

Trafford (GKP, LEE, £5.0m, XI) - 3.87 xPts, high confidence

+ 4 clean sheets and 37 saves this season.
+ Regular starter with secure minutes.
+ Projects 3.9 pts, #1 of 75 GKPs this gameweek.
! Difficult fixture: CHE (away), FDR 4.

Van Hecke (DEF, TOT, £5.1m, XI) - 4.92 xPts, high confidence

+ 2 goals and 0 assists this season (xGI 2.4).
+ Defensive returns: 4 clean sheets.
+ Regular starter with secure minutes.
+ Favourable fixture: IPS (home), FDR 2.
+ Projects 4.9 pts, #1 of 219 DEFs this gameweek.

De Cuyper (DEF, BHA, £5.5m, XI) - 4.10 xPts, high confidence

+ 2 goals and 4 assists this season (xGI 3.9).
+ Strong underlying attacking numbers: 0.43 xGI per 90.
+ Defensive returns: 7 clean sheets.
+ Regular starter with secure minutes.
+ HUL (away) are a low-scoring side: good clean-sheet odds.
+ Favourable fixture: HUL (away), FDR 2.
+ Projects 4.1 pts, #6 of 219 DEFs this gameweek.

Vuskovic (DEF, BHA, £5.3m, XI) - 4.12 xPts, high confidence

+ 1 goals and 2 assists this season (xGI 1.5).
+ Defensive returns: 7 clean sheets.
+ Regular starter with secure minutes.
+ HUL (away) are a low-scoring side: good clean-sheet odds.
+ Favourable fixture: HUL (away), FDR 2.
+ Projects 4.1 pts, #5 of 219 DEFs this gameweek.

Tavernier (MID, BOU, £6.7m, XI) - 4.92 xPts, high confidence
+ 5 goals and 0 assists this season (xGI 5.7).
+ Strong underlying attacking numbers: 0.61 xGI per 90.
+ Regular starter with secure minutes.
+ Projects 4.9 pts, #1 of 299 MIDs this gameweek.

Mbeumo (MID, MUN, £7.9m, XI) - 3.78 xPts, high confidence
+ 4 goals and 1 assists this season (xGI 5.9).
+ Strong underlying attacking numbers: 0.60 xGI per 90.
+ Regular starter with secure minutes.
+ Projects 3.8 pts, #11 of 299 MIDs this gameweek.
! Difficult fixture: LIV (away), FDR 4.

E.Le Fée (MID, SUN, £5.7m, XI) - 4.40 xPts, high confidence
+ 3 goals and 1 assists this season (xGI 5.7).
+ Strong underlying attacking numbers: 0.59 xGI per 90.
+ Regular starter with secure minutes.
+ AVL (away) concede 1.59 goals/game vs league 1.36.
+ Projects 4.4 pts, #3 of 299 MIDs this gameweek.

Ødegaard (MID, ARS, £6.7m, XI) - 4.25 xPts, high confidence
+ 3 goals and 0 assists this season (xGI 4.9).
+ Strong underlying attacking numbers: 0.53 xGI per 90.
+ Regular starter with secure minutes.
+ NEW (away) concede 1.56 goals/game vs league 1.36.
+ Projects 4.3 pts, #4 of 299 MIDs this gameweek.

Haaland (FWD, MCI, £15.8m, XI, CAPTAIN) - 5.52 xPts, high confidence
+ 9 goals and 0 assists this season (xGI 7.9).
+ Strong underlying attacking numbers: 0.80 xGI per 90.
+ First-choice penalty taker.
+ Regular starter with secure minutes.
+ Favourable fixture: FUL (home), FDR 2.
+ Projects 5.5 pts, #1 of 79 FWDs this gameweek.

Barry (FWD, EVE, £5.7m, XI) - 4.65 xPts, high confidence
+ 6 goals and 1 assists this season (xGI 7.8).
+ Strong underlying attacking numbers: 0.82 xGI per 90.
+ First-choice penalty taker.
+ Regular starter with secure minutes.
+ Projects 4.7 pts, #5 of 79 FWDs this gameweek.
! Difficult fixture: BRE (away), FDR 4.

Isak (FWD, LIV, £9.3m, XI, VICE-CAPTAIN) - 5.50 xPts, high confidence
+ 7 goals and 0 assists this season (xGI 5.2).
+ Strong underlying attacking numbers: 0.62 xGI per 90.
+ Regular starter with secure minutes.
+ MUN (home) concede 1.71 goals/game vs league 1.36.
+ Projects 5.5 pts, #2 of 79 FWDs this gameweek.

Tzolakis (GKP, HUL, £4.7m, bench 1) - 3.58 xPts, high confidence
+ 3 clean sheets and 41 saves this season.
+ Regular starter with secure minutes.
+ Projects 3.6 pts, #2 of 75 GKPs this gameweek.
! Difficult fixture: BHA (home), FDR 4.

Groß (MID, BHA, £6.3m, bench 2) - 4.15 xPts, high confidence
+ 4 goals and 6 assists this season (xGI 5.3).
+ Strong underlying attacking numbers: 0.54 xGI per 90.
+ First-choice penalty taker.
+ Regular starter with secure minutes.
+ Favourable fixture: HUL (away), FDR 2.
+ Projects 4.2 pts, #7 of 299 MIDs this gameweek.

Muharemović (DEF, LEE, £5.1m, bench 3) - 3.80 xPts, high confidence
+ 0 goals and 2 assists this season (xGI 0.9).
+ Defensive returns: 4 clean sheets.
+ Regularly reaches the defensive-contribution threshold.
+ Regular starter with secure minutes.
+ Projects 3.8 pts, #8 of 219 DEFs this gameweek.
! Difficult fixture: CHE (away), FDR 4.

Silva (DEF, BOU, £5.1m, bench 4) - 4.28 xPts, high confidence
+ Regularly reaches the defensive-contribution threshold.
+ Regular starter with secure minutes.
+ Projects 4.3 pts, #4 of 219 DEFs this gameweek.

Replacement shortlist (Team Builder)

Team Builder generates a new squad, so there are no transfers to recommend. Below: the best legal replacements for each player within budget, by expected points.

Player	Best legal replacements (xPts, £m, squad change)
Ødegaard	Rudoni 4.5xPts £4.9m (+0.2) | McGinn 4.2xPts £5.4m (-0.0) | Dewsbury-Hall 3.8xPts £6.7m (-0.1)
Tavernier	Rudoni 4.5xPts £4.9m (-0.5) | McGinn 4.2xPts £5.4m (-0.7) | Dewsbury-Hall 3.8xPts £6.7m (-0.8)
Van Hecke	Jacquet 3.8xPts £5.1m (-0.8) | Ajer 3.8xPts £4.5m (-0.8) | Konsa 3.6xPts £4.8m (-0.8)
De Cuyper	Hill 4.5xPts £5.6m (+0.3) | Jacquet 3.8xPts £5.1m (+0.0) | Ajer 3.8xPts £4.5m (+0.0)
Groß	Rudoni 4.5xPts £4.9m (+0.3) | McGinn 4.2xPts £5.4m (+0.1) | Lewis-Potter 3.8xPts £5.5m (-0.1)
Barry	Emersonn 3.4xPts £5.4m (-0.6) | McBurnie 3.4xPts £5.5m (-0.6) | Delap 3.0xPts £5.3m (-0.6)
Muharemović	Jacquet 3.8xPts £5.1m (+0.0) | Ajer 3.8xPts £4.5m (+0.0) | Konsa 3.6xPts £4.8m (+0.0)
Isak	N.Jackson 4.9xPts £7.1m (-0.6) | Evanilson 4.8xPts £6.5m (-0.7) | Calvert-Lewin 3.9xPts £6.0m (-1.4)
Trafford	Kinsky 3.4xPts £4.4m (-0.3) | Kelleher 3.3xPts £5.0m (-0.3) | Suzuki 3.3xPts £5.0m (-0.3)
Haaland	N.Jackson 4.9xPts £7.1m (-0.6) | Evanilson 4.8xPts £6.5m (-0.7) | Calvert-Lewin 3.9xPts £6.0m (-1.4)
Mbeumo	Rudoni 4.5xPts £4.9m (+0.3) | Wirtz 4.2xPts £7.2m (+0.1) | McGinn 4.2xPts £5.4m (+0.1)
Vuskovic	Jacquet 3.8xPts £5.1m (-0.0) | Ajer 3.8xPts £4.5m (-0.0) | Truffert 3.8xPts £5.4m (-0.0)
E.Le Fée	Rudoni 4.5xPts £4.9m (+0.1) | McGinn 4.2xPts £5.4m (-0.2) | Lewis-Potter 3.8xPts £5.5m (-0.3)
Silva	Jacquet 3.8xPts £5.1m (-0.2) | Ajer 3.8xPts £4.5m (-0.2) | Konsa 3.6xPts £4.8m (-0.2)
Tzolakis	Kinsky 3.4xPts £4.4m (+0.0) | Petrović 3.2xPts £4.5m (+0.0) | Rushworth 3.2xPts £4.5m (+0.0)

Model, confidence and known limitations

Deterministic expected-points model built from FPL's scoring table: appearance + goals + assists + clean sheet + goals conceded + saves + defensive contribution + bonus + cards, with a bounded form tilt. Goal/assist rates blend 0.8*xG/xA + 0.2*actual, shrunk to the positional average by minutes (reliability = minutes/(minutes+450)). Fixture strength uses opponents' goals and xG for/against with home advantage. Squads come from an integer-linear-programming optimiser (not an LLM).
confidenceScore = 0.45*sample size + 0.25*availability certainty + 0.30*start probability; high >= 0.7, medium >= 0.45, else low.
Backtest (GW5-GW10, 1338 player-gameweeks): model MAE 2.3 vs points-per-game baseline 2.57; bias 0.05; captain avg 5.33 vs 2.67. Small sample (6 gameweeks); availability news is not point-in-time in the backtest.
- xPts are estimates; the model has no access to team news beyond FPL's status/news fields.
- No shots-on-target or box-touch data; opponent xGC is derived from the first-choice goalkeeper.
- Future prices are not predicted; selling prices use today's prices.
- Small backtest sample; weights are heuristics, not fitted.

Balanced Plus: strategy definition

A fourth strategy next to Balanced, Safe and Aggressive: a diversified, minutes-secure squad judged over five gameweeks, built on underlying xG/xA rather than recent form.

- At most 2 players from any one club in the starting XI (the squad still obeys the FPL limit of 3).
- XI players must be secure starters: start probability >= 75%, >= 60 expected minutes, availability >= 90%.
- Objective value = discounted xPts over the next five gameweeks (weights 1 / 0.9 / 0.8 / 0.7 / 0.6), scaled by minutes security (0.6 + 0.2 x start probability + 0.2 x min(1, expected minutes / 80)).
- Inside the objective, the player's own goal and assist terms are rebuilt from xG and xA only (realised goals and assists are excluded from those two terms). Bonus points, defensive contribution, saves, cards, team goals conceded and minutes/starts still come from realised data, exactly as in the shared projection model.
- The recent-form tilt is removed from the objective. It is NOT removed from the displayed xPts or breakdown, and captaincy is chosen from the displayed xPts, so form can still influence the armband.
- Strong playable bench: every outfield sub must have >= 50% start probability, the bench counts for 25% of a starter's value (Balanced: 12%), and the four bench players must total >= 12 xPts when feasible.
- Captain = highest displayed (raw model) xPts in the XI, chosen independently of the squad objective. Vice = best remaining secure starter (>= 85% start) from a different club to the captain.
- Same FPL data snapshot and same £100m budget as the other three strategies.

What the Balanced Plus objective uses, and what this report displays

Two different numbers exist for every player. DISPLAYED xPts (tables, breakdown, captaincy, comparison metrics) come from the shared projection engine used by all four strategies. The Balanced Plus OBJECTIVE VALUE (what the solver maximises) is a separate five-gameweek quantity derived from it. The per-player table in this report shows both.
Displayed xPts use realised data as follows: goals and assists: 80% xG/xA + 20% realised; bonus, saves, defensive contribution and cards: realised per-90 rates; clean sheets and goals conceded: team goals against (50% realised) and xGA; minutes and starts: realised; positional priors include realised totals.
Objective: Excluded: the player's own realised goals and assists. Still included: bonus, defensive contribution, saves, cards, team goals conceded, minutes and starts.
Form: Removed from the objective only. Present in displayed xPts (mean absolute size about 0.03 xPts per player; up to ~0.3) and therefore in captaincy.
Minutes: Applied on top of a projection that already scales by expected minutes, so minutes are deliberately counted twice.
Displayed = shared-model xPts (GW = this gameweek, 5-GW = discounted average). Objective = the Balanced Plus value the solver maximised. Form xPts removed and the xG/xA rebuild are the 5-GW adjustments between the two.

Player	Displayed GW	Objective GW	Displayed 5-GW	Objective 5-GW	Form xPts removed	xG/xA rebuild	Start %
Trafford	3.87	3.84	4.05	4.02	0.03	0.00	100%
Van Hecke	4.92	4.82	4.45	4.36	0.10	0.00	100%
De Cuyper	4.10	4.08	4.26	4.24	-0.08	-0.06	97%
Vuskovic	4.12	4.06	4.21	4.15	0.02	-0.04	100%
Tavernier	4.92	4.85	4.63	4.57	0.04	0.00	98%
Mbeumo	3.78	3.88	4.30	4.43	-0.08	0.05	100%
E.Le Fée	4.40	4.36	4.34	4.30	0.10	0.08	99%
Ødegaard	4.25	4.26	4.18	4.19	0.00	0.05	97%
Haaland	5.52	5.49	5.10	5.08	-0.04	-0.06	100%
Barry	4.65	4.58	4.87	4.79	0.09	0.04	98%
Isak	5.50	5.13	4.91	4.59	0.01	-0.10	88%
Tzolakis	3.58	3.66	3.62	3.70	-0.08	0.00	100%
Groß	4.15	4.08	4.36	4.28	-0.11	-0.19	99%
Muharemović	3.80	3.73	4.08	4.00	0.06	-0.02	100%
Silva	4.28	4.19	3.97	3.88	0.18	0.10	100%

Historical validation (rolling backtest)

Balanced Plus is competitive, but no advantage over Balanced is established. (58 held-out windows)

- Held-out seasons 2024-25 and 2025-26: 58 rolling five-gameweek windows (12 non-overlapping).

- Balanced Plus minus Balanced: mean +5.6 points per window (median -1.5, SD 33.6); 95% CI -19.7 to +26.0 (t, non-overlapping) and -2.1 to +15.3 (block bootstrap).
- By season: 2024-25 +15.9, 2025-26 -4.6. Development season 2023-24: +19.8 (not used as evidence).

Limitations of this validation:

- Only two held-out seasons (12 independent five-gameweek windows): differences smaller than about 6 points per gameweek cannot be detected.
- No point-in-time injury or availability news exists; a past-minutes proxy is used for every strategy.
- One squad is held for five gameweeks (no transfers, chips or price changes), so season-long play is not tested.
- Fixtures are the final schedule and prices are up to a week stale; the source is a third-party scrape assumed accurate.
- 2022-23 was excluded (the source lacks starts and xG for the first gameweeks); 2026-27 has too few gameweeks.
- The strategy's parameters were not tuned on any window, but its ideas were designed with prior FPL knowledge; sensitivity results are exploratory.

Full method, data limits and sensitivity analysis: docs/BALANCED_PLUS_BACKTEST.md. A difference is claimed only if both 95% intervals exclude zero and the sign agrees in each held-out season.

Strategy comparison: Balanced Plus vs Balanced, Safe and Aggressive (same data snapshot, £100m)

Metric	Balanced	Safe	Aggressive	Balanced Plus
Formation	4-3-3	4-3-3	3-4-3	3-4-3
Squad cost / bank	£99.8m / £0.2m	£100.0m / £0.0m	£96.8m / £3.2m	£99.9m / £0.1m
GW11 xPts (XI + captain)	57.14	56.67	56.74	55.55
Five-gameweek xPts (sum)	276.19	275.92	271.98	276.60
Five-gameweek xPts (discounted)	221.13	220.97	218.02	221.20
xPts per gameweek	57.1 / 53.8 / 53.6 / 56.9 / 54.7	56.7 / 54.6 / 54.2 / 55.3 / 55.2	56.7 / 52.6 / 54.0 / 55.7 / 53.0	55.5 / 55.7 / 53.7 / 55.7 / 56.0
Max players from one club in XI	3	3	3	2
Clubs with 3+ in XI	BOU x3	BOU x3	BOU x3	none
XI avg / min start probability	96% / 87%	98% / 88%	97% / 87%	98% / 88%
XI avg expected minutes	77	79	78	79
XI players below the security bar	none	none	none	none
Bench xPts (GW11) / outfield start prob	15.8 / 96%	16.3 / 95%	15.5 / 96%	15.8 / 100%
XI outfield xGI per 90 (sum)	4.35	4.68	4.81	5.39
Assist share of XI xGI	23%	22%	22%	22%
Displayed form tilt inside XI xPts (not in the BP objective)	0.99	0.86	0.88	0.21
Average model confidence	82%	83%	82%	83%
Captain (xPts, start %)	Haaland (5.52, 100%)	Haaland (5.52, 100%)	Haaland (5.52, 100%)	Haaland (5.52, 100%)
Vice-captain (same club as captain?)	Isak	Isak	Isak	Isak

GW11 xPts = the XI each strategy actually chose + its captain's extra points. GW12 onward use each squad's best XI (unconstrained) so every strategy is measured the same way.
All four strategies use the same FPL data snapshot and the same £100m budget; Balanced, Safe and Aggressive come from the unchanged optimiser.

Summary

- vs Balanced: GW11 xPts -1.59, five-gameweek xPts +0.41, max per club in XI 2 vs 3, XI form-tilt xPts 0.21 vs 0.99, XI xGI/90 5.39 vs 4.35.
- vs Safe: GW11 xPts -1.12, five-gameweek xPts +0.68, max per club in XI 2 vs 3, XI form-tilt xPts 0.21 vs 0.86, XI xGI/90 5.39 vs 4.68.
- vs Aggressive: GW11 xPts -1.19, five-gameweek xPts +4.62, max per club in XI 2 vs 3, XI form-tilt xPts 0.21 vs 0.88, XI xGI/90 5.39 vs 4.81.

Balanced Plus vs Balanced: 6 player change(s), 2 role change(s), 9/15 players shared

Pos	Out (Balanced)	In (Balanced Plus)	GW11 xPts	5-GW value
GKP	Kinsky (TOT, £4.4m, bench)	Tzolakis (HUL, £4.7m, bench)	3.36 -> 3.58	3.22 -> 3.70
DEF	Gabriel (ARS, £8.1m, XI)	De Cuyper (BHA, £5.5m, XI)	4.39 -> 4.10	4.26 -> 4.24
DEF	Hill (BOU, £5.6m, XI)	Muharemović (LEE, £5.1m, bench)	4.45 -> 3.80	4.03 -> 4.00
MID	Rudoni (COV, £4.9m, XI)	Mbeumo (MUN, £7.9m, XI)	4.47 -> 3.78	3.69 -> 4.43

Pos	Out (Balanced)	In (Balanced Plus)	GW11 xPts	5-GW value
MID	McGinn (AVL, £5.4m, bench)	Ødegaard (ARS, £6.7m, XI)	4.21 -> 4.25	3.93 -> 4.19
FWD	N.Jackson (AVL, £7.1m, XI)	Barry (EVE, £5.7m, XI)	4.90 -> 4.65	4.31 -> 4.79

Kinsky -> Tzolakis
Out: Lower five-gameweek value: 3.22 vs 3.70 for Tzolakis.
In: Fit substitute keeper: 100% start probability, 100% available.
In: Five-gameweek value 3.70 (raw model 3.62); next-five fixture difficulty 3.2.

Gabriel -> De Cuyper
Out: Squad-level trade-off: De Cuyper is not individually better (five-gameweek value 4.24 vs 4.26); the optimiser chose the combination with the highest total five-gameweek value under the XI club cap, the bench target and £100m.
Out: Price: Gabriel £8.1m vs De Cuyper £5.5m (£2.6m cheaper with Balanced Plus).
In: Secure starter: 97% start probability, ~78 expected minutes.
In: Underlying attack: xGI/90 0.43 (xG 2.4, xA 1.5), not just returns (2G 4A).
In: Five-gameweek value 4.24 (raw model 4.26); next-five fixture difficulty 2.8.
In: Keeps BHA at 2 in the XI (limit 2).

Hill -> Muharemović
Out: Balanced started 3 BOU players (Hill, Silva, Tavernier); Balanced Plus allows at most 2 per club in the XI.
Out: 0.17 xPts (5-GW average) of the projection came from the recent-form tilt, which Balanced Plus removes.
Out: Price: Hill £5.6m vs Muharemović £5.1m (£0.5m cheaper with Balanced Plus).
In: Playable bench option: 100% start probability, 100% available.
In: Underlying attack: xGI/90 0.08 (xG 0.7, xA 0.2), not just returns (0G 2A).
In: Five-gameweek value 4.00 (raw model 4.08); next-five fixture difficulty 3.4.

Rudoni -> Mbeumo
Out: Lower five-gameweek value: 3.69 vs 4.43 for Mbeumo.
Out: Price: Rudoni £4.9m vs Mbeumo £7.9m (£3.0m dearer with Balanced Plus).
In: Secure starter: 100% start probability, ~80 expected minutes.
In: Underlying attack: xGI/90 0.60 (xG 4.6, xA 1.3), not just returns (4G 1A).
In: Five-gameweek value 4.43 (raw model 4.30); next-five fixture difficulty 2.8.
In: Keeps MUN at 1 in the XI (limit 2).

McGinn -> Ødegaard
Out: Lower five-gameweek value: 3.93 vs 4.19 for Ødegaard.
Out: Price: McGinn £5.4m vs Ødegaard £6.7m (£1.3m dearer with Balanced Plus).
In: Secure starter: 97% start probability, ~78 expected minutes.
In: Underlying attack: xGI/90 0.53 (xG 2.4, xA 2.5), not just returns (3G 0A).
In: Five-gameweek value 4.19 (raw model 4.18); next-five fixture difficulty 3.4.
In: Keeps ARS at 1 in the XI (limit 2).

N.Jackson -> Barry
Out: 0.15 xPts (5-GW average) of the projection came from the recent-form tilt, which Balanced Plus removes.
Out: Realised returns (6G 1A) outrun underlying numbers (xG 3.5, xA 0.9); rebuilt on xG/xA the value drops 0.15.
Out: Lower five-gameweek value: 4.31 vs 4.79 for Barry.
Out: Price: N.Jackson £7.1m vs Barry £5.7m (£1.4m cheaper with Balanced Plus).
In: Secure starter: 98% start probability, ~79 expected minutes.
In: Underlying attack: xGI/90 0.82 (xG 7.3, xA 0.5), not just returns (6G 1A).
In: Five-gameweek value 4.79 (raw model 4.87); next-five fixture difficulty 3.4.
In: Keeps EVE at 1 in the XI (limit 2).

Role changes (same player, different role):
- Vuskovic moves from bench to XI. Secure starter (100% start, ~80 min) with five-gameweek value 4.15. Within the 2-per-club XI limit (BHA: 2).
- Silva moves from XI to bench. Balanced started 3 BOU players; Balanced Plus keeps at most 2 in the XI and Silva is not among its top 2 by value for this gameweek. Five-gameweek value 3.88 ranks below the players Balanced Plus starts.

Captain: Balanced: Haaland (5.52 xPts) | Balanced Plus: Haaland (5.52 xPts): same pick (highest model xPts in the XI). Vice: Balanced: Isak | Balanced Plus: Isak: same pick.

Balanced Plus vs Safe: 3 player change(s), 2 role change(s), 12/15 players shared

Pos	Out (Safe)	In (Balanced Plus)	GW11 xPts	5-GW value
DEF	Gabriel (ARS, £8.1m, XI)	De Cuyper (BHA, £5.5m, XI)	4.39 -> 4.10	4.26 -> 4.24
DEF	Hill (BOU, £5.6m, XI)	Muharemović (LEE, £5.1m, bench)	4.45 -> 3.80	4.03 -> 4.00
MID	Rudoni (COV, £4.9m, bench)	Mbeumo (MUN, £7.9m, XI)	4.47 -> 3.78	3.69 -> 4.43

Gabriel -> De Cuyper
Out: Squad-level trade-off: De Cuyper is not individually better (five-gameweek value 4.24 vs 4.26); the optimiser chose the combination with the highest total five-gameweek value under the XI club cap, the bench target and £100m.
Out: Price: Gabriel £8.1m vs De Cuyper £5.5m (£2.6m cheaper with Balanced Plus).
In: Secure starter: 97% start probability, ~78 expected minutes.
In: Underlying attack: xGI/90 0.43 (xG 2.4, xA 1.5), not just returns (2G 4A).
In: Five-gameweek value 4.24 (raw model 4.26); next-five fixture difficulty 2.8.
In: Keeps BHA at 2 in the XI (limit 2).

Hill -> Muharemović
Out: Safe started 3 BOU players (Hill, Silva, Tavernier); Balanced Plus allows at most 2 per club in the XI.
Out: 0.17 xPts (5-GW average) of the projection came from the recent-form tilt, which Balanced Plus removes.
Out: Price: Hill £5.6m vs Muharemović £5.1m (£0.5m cheaper with Balanced Plus).
In: Playable bench option: 100% start probability, 100% available.
In: Underlying attack: xGI/90 0.08 (xG 0.7, xA 0.2), not just returns (0G 2A).
In: Five-gameweek value 4.00 (raw model 4.08); next-five fixture difficulty 3.4.

Rudoni -> Mbeumo
Out: Lower five-gameweek value: 3.69 vs 4.43 for Mbeumo.
Out: Price: Rudoni £4.9m vs Mbeumo £7.9m (£3.0m dearer with Balanced Plus).
In: Secure starter: 100% start probability, ~80 expected minutes.
In: Underlying attack: xGI/90 0.60 (xG 4.6, xA 1.3), not just returns (4G 1A).
In: Five-gameweek value 4.43 (raw model 4.30); next-five fixture difficulty 2.8.
In: Keeps MUN at 1 in the XI (limit 2).

Role changes (same player, different role):
• Vuskovic moves from bench to XI. Secure starter (100% start, ~80 min) with five-gameweek value 4.15. Within the 2-per-club XI limit (BHA: 2).
• Silva moves from XI to bench. Safe started 3 BOU players; Balanced Plus keeps at most 2 in the XI and Silva is not among its top 2 by value for this gameweek. Five-gameweek value 3.88 ranks below the players Balanced Plus starts.

Captain: Safe: Haaland (5.52 xPts) | Balanced Plus: Haaland (5.52 xPts): same pick (highest model xPts in the XI). Vice: Safe: Isak | Balanced Plus: Isak: same pick.

Balanced Plus vs Aggressive: 6 player change(s), 2 role change(s), 9/15 players shared

Pos	Out (Aggressive)	In (Balanced Plus)	GW11 xPts	5-GW value
GKP	A.Becker (LIV, £5.5m, bench)	Tzolakis (HUL, £4.7m, bench)	3.43 -> 3.58	3.36 -> 3.70
DEF	Hill (BOU, £5.6m, XI)	De Cuyper (BHA, £5.5m, XI)	4.45 -> 4.10	4.03 -> 4.24
DEF	Ajer (BRE, £4.5m, bench)	Muharemović (LEE, £5.1m, bench)	3.76 -> 3.80	3.47 -> 4.00
MID	Rudoni (COV, £4.9m, XI)	Mbeumo (MUN, £7.9m, XI)	4.47 -> 3.78	3.69 -> 4.43
MID	Wirtz (LIV, £7.2m, XI)	Ødegaard (ARS, £6.7m, XI)	4.24 -> 4.25	3.65 -> 4.19
MID	McGinn (AVL, £5.4m, bench)	Groß (BHA, £6.3m, bench)	4.21 -> 4.15	3.93 -> 4.28

A.Becker -> Tzolakis
Out: Lower five-gameweek value: 3.36 vs 3.70 for Tzolakis.
Out: Price: A.Becker £5.5m vs Tzolakis £4.7m (£0.8m cheaper with Balanced Plus).
In: Fit substitute keeper: 100% start probability, 100% available.
In: Five-gameweek value 3.70 (raw model 3.62); next-five fixture difficulty 3.2.

Hill -> De Cuyper
Out: Aggressive started 3 BOU players (Hill, Silva, Tavernier); Balanced Plus allows at most 2 per club in the XI.
Out: 0.17 xPts (5-GW average) of the projection came from the recent-form tilt, which Balanced Plus removes.
Out: Lower five-gameweek value: 4.03 vs 4.24 for De Cuyper.
In: Secure starter: 97% start probability, ~78 expected minutes.
In: Underlying attack: xGI/90 0.43 (xG 2.4, xA 1.5), not just returns (2G 4A).
In: Five-gameweek value 4.24 (raw model 4.26); next-five fixture difficulty 2.8.

In: Keeps BHA at 2 in the XI (limit 2).

Ajer -> Muharemović

Out: Lower five-gameweek value: 3.47 vs 4.00 for Muharemović.
Out: Price: Ajer £4.5m vs Muharemović £5.1m (£0.6m dearer with Balanced Plus).
In: Playable bench option: 100% start probability, 100% available.
In: Underlying attack: xGI/90 0.08 (xG 0.7, xA 0.2), not just returns (0G 2A).
In: Five-gameweek value 4.00 (raw model 4.08); next-five fixture difficulty 3.4.

Rudoni -> Mbeumo

Out: Lower five-gameweek value: 3.69 vs 4.43 for Mbeumo.
Out: Price: Rudoni £4.9m vs Mbeumo £7.9m (£3.0m dearer with Balanced Plus).
In: Secure starter: 100% start probability, ~80 expected minutes.
In: Underlying attack: xGI/90 0.60 (xG 4.6, xA 1.3), not just returns (4G 1A).
In: Five-gameweek value 4.43 (raw model 4.30); next-five fixture difficulty 2.8.
In: Keeps MUN at 1 in the XI (limit 2).

Wirtz -> Ødegaard

Out: Lower five-gameweek value: 3.65 vs 4.19 for Ødegaard.
Out: Price: Wirtz £7.2m vs Ødegaard £6.7m (£0.5m cheaper with Balanced Plus).
In: Secure starter: 97% start probability, ~78 expected minutes.
In: Underlying attack: xGI/90 0.53 (xG 2.4, xA 2.5), not just returns (3G 0A).
In: Five-gameweek value 4.19 (raw model 4.18); next-five fixture difficulty 3.4.
In: Keeps ARS at 1 in the XI (limit 2).

McGinn -> Groß

Out: Lower five-gameweek value: 3.93 vs 4.28 for Groß.
Out: Price: McGinn £5.4m vs Groß £6.3m (£0.9m dearer with Balanced Plus).
In: Playable bench option: 99% start probability, 100% available.
In: Underlying attack: xGI/90 0.54 (xG 3.0, xA 2.2), not just returns (4G 6A).
In: Five-gameweek value 4.28 (raw model 4.36); next-five fixture difficulty 2.8.

Role changes (same player, different role):

- Vuskovic moves from bench to XI. Secure starter (100% start, ~80 min) with five-gameweek value 4.15. Within the 2-per-club XI limit (BHA: 2).
- Silva moves from XI to bench. Aggressive started 3 BOU players; Balanced Plus keeps at most 2 in the XI and Silva is not among its top 2 by value for this gameweek. Five-gameweek value 3.88 ranks below the players Balanced Plus starts.

Captain: Aggressive: Haaland (5.52 xPts) | Balanced Plus: Haaland (5.52 xPts): same pick (highest model xPts in the XI). Vice: Aggressive: Isak | Balanced Plus: Isak: same pick.

Structured data (machine-readable)

The complete report as JSON follows (also attached to this PDF as a file). Line breaks inside long strings are layout wrapping only.


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  "pointsPerGame": 7,
  "form": 7.5
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 "projection": {
  "gw": 11,
  "xPts": 4.12,
  "confidence": "high",
  "confidenceScore": 0.84,
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  "startProbability": 1,
  "availability": 1,
  "expectedMinutes": 80,
  "fixtures": [{"opponent":"HUL","home":false,"fdr":2,"kickoff":"2026-11-22T14:00:00Z"}],
  "breakdown": {
   "appearance": 1.92,
   "goals": 0.46,
   "assists": 0.14,
   "cleanSheet": 1.06,
   "goalsConceded": -0.37,
   "saves": 0,
   "defContrib": 0.62,
   "bonus": 0.34,
   "cards": -0.07,
   "formAdj": 0.02
  }
 },
 "upcomingFiveGws": [
  {"gw":11,"xPts":4.12,"fixtures":["HUL(A) FDR2"]},
  {"gw":12,"xPts":4.7,"fixtures":["NEW(H) FDR3"]},
  {"gw":13,"xPts":3.78,"fixtures":["BOU(A) FDR4"]},
  {"gw":14,"xPts":3.97,"fixtures":["NFO(A) FDR2"]},
  {"gw":15,"xPts":4.49,"fixtures":["EVE(H) FDR3"]}
 ],
 "whySelected": [
  "1 goals and 2 assists this season (xGI 1.5).",
  "Defensive returns: 7 clean sheets.",
  "Regular starter with secure minutes.",
  "HUL (away) are a low-scoring side: good clean-sheet odds.",
  "Favourable fixture: HUL (away), FDR 2.",
  "Projects 4.1 pts, #5 of 219 DEFs this gameweek."
 ],
 "warnings": []
},
{
 "id": 68,
 "name": "Tavernier",
 "fullName": "Marcus Tavernier",
 "club": "BOU",
 "position": "MID",
 "role": "starting",
 "slot": 5,
 "benchOrder": null,
 "isCaptain": false,
 "isViceCaptain": false,
 "priceM": 6.7,
 "ownershipPct": 31.4,
 "status": "a",
 "news": null,
 "season": {
  "minutes": 840,
  "starts": 10,
  "goals": 5,
  "assists": 0,
  "xG": 4.21,
  "xA": 1.45,
  "xGI": 5.66,
  "xGI_per90": 0.61,
  "cleanSheets": 3,
  "saves": 0,
  "bonus": 12,
  "defensiveContributionPer90": 8.36,
  "totalPoints": 58,
  "pointsPerGame": 5.8,
  "form": 6.5
 },
 "projection": {
  "gw": 11,
  "xPts": 4.92,
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  "confidence": "high",
  "confidenceScore": 0.82,
  "startProbability": 0.98,
  "availability": 1,
  "expectedMinutes": 79,
  "fixtures": [{"opponent":"NFO","home":true,"fdr":3,"kickoff":"2026-11-21T15:00:00Z"}],
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   "appearance": 1.91,
   "goals": 1.62,
   "assists": 0.34,
   "cleanSheet": 0.28,
   "goalsConceded": 0,
   "saves": 0,
   "defContrib": 0.22,
   "bonus": 0.83,
   "cards": -0.32,
   "formAdj": 0.04
  }
 },
 "upcomingFiveGws": [
  {"gw":11,"xPts":4.92,"fixtures":["NFO(H) FDR3"]},
  {"gw":12,"xPts":4.5,"fixtures":["FUL(A) FDR3"]},
  {"gw":13,"xPts":4.65,"fixtures":["BHA(H) FDR4"]},
  {"gw":14,"xPts":5.02,"fixtures":["HUL(H) FDR2"]},
  {"gw":15,"xPts":3.86,"fixtures":["ARS(A) FDR5"]}
 ],
 "whySelected": [
  "5 goals and 0 assists this season (xGI 5.7).",
  "Strong underlying attacking numbers: 0.61 xGI per 90.",
  "Regular starter with secure minutes.",
  "Projects 4.9 pts, #1 of 299 MIDs this gameweek."
 ],
 "warnings": []
},
{
 "id": 427,
 "name": "Mbeumo",
 "fullName": "Bryan Mbeumo",
 "club": "MUN",
 "position": "MID",
 "role": "starting",
 "slot": 6,
 "benchOrder": null,
 "isCaptain": false,
 "isViceCaptain": false,
 "priceM": 7.9,
 "ownershipPct": 19.1,
 "status": "a",
 "news": null,
 "season": {
  "minutes": 892,
  "starts": 10,
  "goals": 4,
  "assists": 1,
  "xG": 4.63,
  "xA": 1.29,
  "xGI": 5.92,
  "xGI_per90": 0.6,
  "cleanSheets": 0,
  "saves": 0,
  "bonus": 5,
  "defensiveContributionPer90": 3.93,
  "totalPoints": 46,
  "pointsPerGame": 4.6,
  "form": 3.2
 },
 "projection": {
  "gw": 11,
  "xPts": 3.78,
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  "confidence": "high",
  "confidenceScore": 0.85,
  "startProbability": 1,
  "availability": 1,
  "expectedMinutes": 80,
  "fixtures": [{"opponent":"LIV","home":false,"fdr":4,"kickoff":"2026-11-22T16:30:00Z"}],
  "breakdown": {
   "appearance": 1.93,
   "goals": 1.3,
   "assists": 0.28,
   "cleanSheet": 0.16,
   "goalsConceded": 0,
   "saves": 0,
   "defContrib": 0.02,
   "bonus": 0.35,
   "cards": -0.19,
   "formAdj": -0.06
  }
 },
 "upcomingFiveGws": [
  {"gw":11,"xPts":3.78,"fixtures":["LIV(A) FDR4"]},
  {"gw":12,"xPts":4.33,"fixtures":["BRE(H) FDR3"]},
  {"gw":13,"xPts":4.17,"fixtures":["NEW(A) FDR3"]},
  {"gw":14,"xPts":4.77,"fixtures":["COV(H) FDR2"]},
  {"gw":15,"xPts":4.76,"fixtures":["CRY(A) FDR2"]}
 ],
 "whySelected": [
  "4 goals and 1 assists this season (xGI 5.9).",
  "Strong underlying attacking numbers: 0.60 xGI per 90.",
  "Regular starter with secure minutes.",
  "Projects 3.8 pts, #11 of 299 MIDs this gameweek."
 ],
 "warnings": ["Difficult fixture: LIV (away), FDR 4."]
},
{
 "id": 542,
 "name": "E.Le Fée",
 "fullName": "Enzo Le Fée",
 "club": "SUN",
 "position": "MID",
 "role": "starting",
 "slot": 7,
 "benchOrder": null,
 "isCaptain": false,
 "isViceCaptain": false,
 "priceM": 5.7,
 "ownershipPct": 2.8,
 "status": "a",
 "news": null,
 "season": {
  "minutes": 863,
  "starts": 10,
  "goals": 3,
  "assists": 1,
  "xG": 3.83,
  "xA": 1.86,
  "xGI": 5.69,
  "xGI_per90": 0.59,
  "cleanSheets": 3,
  "saves": 0,
  "bonus": 5,
  "defensiveContributionPer90": 6.15,
  "totalPoints": 46,
  "pointsPerGame": 4.6,
  "form": 6.5
 },
 "projection": {
  "gw": 11,
  "xPts": 4.4,
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  "confidence": "high",
  "confidenceScore": 0.83,
  "startProbability": 0.99,
  "availability": 1,
  "expectedMinutes": 79,
  "fixtures": [{"opponent":"AVL","home":false,"fdr":3,"kickoff":"2026-11-21T15:00:00Z"}],
  "breakdown": {
   "appearance": 1.92,
   "goals": 1.37,
   "assists": 0.43,
   "cleanSheet": 0.18,
   "goalsConceded": 0,
   "saves": 0,
   "defContrib": 0.08,
   "bonus": 0.39,
   "cards": -0.07,
   "formAdj": 0.1
  }
 },
 "upcomingFiveGws": [
  {"gw":11,"xPts":4.4,"fixtures":["AVL(A) FDR3"]},
  {"gw":12,"xPts":4.45,"fixtures":["TOT(H) FDR3"]},
  {"gw":13,"xPts":3.99,"fixtures":["LIV(A) FDR4"]},
  {"gw":14,"xPts":4.39,"fixtures":["NEW(A) FDR3"]},
  {"gw":15,"xPts":4.49,"fixtures":["NFO(H) FDR3"]}
 ],
 "whySelected": [
  "3 goals and 1 assists this season (xGI 5.7).",
  "Strong underlying attacking numbers: 0.59 xGI per 90.",
  "Regular starter with secure minutes.",
  "AVL (away) concede 1.59 goals/game vs league 1.36.",
  "Projects 4.4 pts, #3 of 299 MIDs this gameweek."
 ],
 "warnings": []
},
{
 "id": 15,
 "name": "Ødegaard",
 "fullName": "Martin Ødegaard",
 "club": "ARS",
 "position": "MID",
 "role": "starting",
 "slot": 8,
 "benchOrder": null,
 "isCaptain": false,
 "isViceCaptain": false,
 "priceM": 6.7,
 "ownershipPct": 16.5,
 "status": "a",
 "news": null,
 "season": {
  "minutes": 823,
  "starts": 10,
  "goals": 3,
  "assists": 0,
  "xG": 2.4,
  "xA": 2.48,
  "xGI": 4.88,
  "xGI_per90": 0.53,
  "cleanSheets": 7,
  "saves": 0,
  "bonus": 9,
  "defensiveContributionPer90": 4.81,
  "totalPoints": 50,
  "pointsPerGame": 5,
  "form": 5
 },
 "projection": {
  "gw": 11,
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  "xPts": 4.25,
  "confidence": "high",
  "confidenceScore": 0.82,
  "startProbability": 0.97,
  "availability": 1,
  "expectedMinutes": 78,
  "fixtures": [{"opponent":"NEW","home":false,"fdr":3,"kickoff":"2026-11-21T17:30:00Z"}],
  "breakdown": {"appearance":1.9,"goals":1.03,"assists":0.49,"cleanSheet":0.29,"goalsConceded":0,"saves":0,"defContrib":0.03,"bonus":0.64,"cards":-0.13,"formAdj":0}
 },
 "upcomingFiveGws": [
  {"gw":11,"xPts":4.25,"fixtures":["NEW(A) FDR3"]},
  {"gw":12,"xPts":4.36,"fixtures":["MCI(H) FDR4"]},
  {"gw":13,"xPts":3.98,"fixtures":["BRE(A) FDR4"]},
  {"gw":14,"xPts":3.92,"fixtures":["TOT(A) FDR3"]},
  {"gw":15,"xPts":4.37,"fixtures":["BOU(H) FDR3"]}
 ],
 "whySelected": [
  "3 goals and 0 assists this season (xGI 4.9).",
  "Strong underlying attacking numbers: 0.53 xGI per 90.",
  "Regular starter with secure minutes.",
  "NEW (away) concede 1.56 goals/game vs league 1.36.",
  "Projects 4.3 pts, #4 of 299 MIDs this gameweek."
 ],
 "warnings": []
},
{
 "id": 411,
 "name": "Haaland",
 "fullName": "Erling Haaland",
 "club": "MCI",
 "position": "FWD",
 "role": "starting",
 "slot": 9,
 "benchOrder": null,
 "isCaptain": true,
 "isViceCaptain": false,
 "priceM": 15.8,
 "ownershipPct": 78.9,
 "status": "a",
 "news": null,
 "season": {
  "minutes": 889,
  "starts": 10,
  "goals": 9,
  "assists": 0,
  "xG": 7.06,
  "xA": 0.87,
  "xGI": 7.93,
  "xGI_per90": 0.8,
  "cleanSheets": 3,
  "saves": 0,
  "bonus": 14,
  "defensiveContributionPer90": 3.24,
  "totalPoints": 70,
  "pointsPerGame": 7,
  "form": 6.2
 },
 "projection": {
  "gw": 11,
  "xPts": 5.52,
  "confidence": "high",
  "confidenceScore": 0.85,
  "startProbability": 1,
  "availability": 1,
  "expectedMinutes": 80,
  "fixtures": [{"opponent":"FUL","home":true,"fdr":2,"kickoff":"2026-11-21T12:30:00Z"}],
  "breakdown": {"appearance":1.93,"goals":2.43,"assists":0.21,"cleanSheet":0,"goalsConceded":0,"saves":0,"defContrib":0,"bonus":1.06,"cards":-0.07,"formAdj":-0.04}
 },
 "upcomingFiveGws": [
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   {"gw":11,"xPts":5.52,"fixtures":["FUL(H) FDR2"]},
   {"gw":12,"xPts":4.17,"fixtures":["ARS(A) FDR5"]},
   {"gw":13,"xPts":5.15,"fixtures":["LEE(H) FDR3"]},
   {"gw":14,"xPts":4.94,"fixtures":["BRE(A) FDR4"]},
   {"gw":15,"xPts":5.91,"fixtures":["CHE(H) FDR4"]}
  ],
  "whySelected": [
   "9 goals and 0 assists this season (xGI 7.9).",
   "Strong underlying attacking numbers: 0.80 xGI per 90.",
   "First-choice penalty taker.",
   "Regular starter with secure minutes.",
   "Favourable fixture: FUL (home), FDR 2.",
   "Projects 5.5 pts, #1 of 79 FWDs this gameweek."
  ],
  "warnings": []
 },
 {
  "id": 249,
  "name": "Barry",
  "fullName": "Thierno Barry",
  "club": "EVE",
  "position": "FWD",
  "role": "starting",
  "slot": 10,
  "benchOrder": null,
  "isCaptain": false,
  "isViceCaptain": false,
  "priceM": 5.7,
  "ownershipPct": 10.7,
  "status": "a",
  "news": null,
  "season": {
   "minutes": 851,
   "starts": 10,
   "goals": 6,
   "assists": 1,
   "xG": 7.29,
   "xA": 0.48,
   "xGI": 7.77,
   "xGI_per90": 0.82,
   "cleanSheets": 4,
   "saves": 0,
   "bonus": 8,
   "defensiveContributionPer90": 3.49,
   "totalPoints": 55,
   "pointsPerGame": 5.5,
   "form": 7.2
  },
  "projection": {
   "gw": 11,
   "xPts": 4.65,
   "confidence": "high",
   "confidenceScore": 0.83,
   "startProbability": 0.98,
   "availability": 1,
   "expectedMinutes": 79,
   "fixtures": [{"opponent":"BRE","home":false,"fdr":4,"kickoff":"2026-11-23T20:00:00Z"}],
   "breakdown": {"appearance":1.91,"goals":1.93,"assists":0.16,"cleanSheet":0,"goalsConceded":0,"saves":0,"defContrib":0,"bonus":0.64,"cards":-0.07,"formAdj":0.08}
  },
  "upcomingFiveGws": [
   {"gw":11,"xPts":4.65,"fixtures":["BRE(A) FDR4"]},
   {"gw":12,"xPts":5.03,"fixtures":["LIV(H) FDR4"]},
   {"gw":13,"xPts":5.06,"fixtures":["AVL(A) FDR3"]},
   {"gw":14,"xPts":5.21,"fixtures":["FUL(H) FDR2"]},
   {"gw":15,"xPts":4.37,"fixtures":["BHA(A) FDR4"]}
  ],
  "whySelected": [
   "6 goals and 1 assists this season (xGI 7.8).",
   "Strong underlying attacking numbers: 0.82 xGI per 90.",
```

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  "First-choice penalty taker.",
  "Regular starter with secure minutes.",
  "Projects 4.7 pts, #5 of 79 FWDs this gameweek."
 ],
 "warnings": ["Difficult fixture: BRE (away), FDR 4."]
},
{
 "id": 379,
 "name": "Isak",
 "fullName": "Alexander Isak",
 "club": "LIV",
 "position": "FWD",
 "role": "starting",
 "slot": 11,
 "benchOrder": null,
 "isCaptain": false,
 "isViceCaptain": true,
 "priceM": 9.3,
 "ownershipPct": 25.1,
 "status": "a",
 "news": null,
 "season": {
  "minutes": 747,
  "starts": 9,
  "goals": 7,
  "assists": 0,
  "xG": 4.88,
  "xA": 0.28,
  "xGI": 5.16,
  "xGI_per90": 0.62,
  "cleanSheets": 5,
  "saves": 0,
  "bonus": 16,
  "defensiveContributionPer90": 1.81,
  "totalPoints": 61,
  "pointsPerGame": 6.8,
  "form": 7
 },
 "projection": {
  "gw": 11,
  "xPts": 5.5,
  "confidence": "high",
  "confidenceScore": 0.76,
  "startProbability": 0.88,
  "availability": 1,
  "expectedMinutes": 72,
  "fixtures": [{"opponent":"MUN","home":true,"fdr":3,"kickoff":"2026-11-22T16:30:00Z"}],
  "breakdown": {"appearance":1.79,"goals":2.33,"assists":0.15,"cleanSheet":0,"goalsConceded":0,"saves":0,"defContrib":0,"bonus":1.33,"cards":-0.13,"formAdj":0.01}
 },
 "upcomingFiveGws": [
  {"gw":11,"xPts":5.5,"fixtures":["MUN(H) FDR3"]},
  {"gw":12,"xPts":4.32,"fixtures":["EVE(A) FDR3"]},
  {"gw":13,"xPts":5.31,"fixtures":["SUN(H) FDR2"]},
  {"gw":14,"xPts":4.67,"fixtures":["CHE(A) FDR4"]},
  {"gw":15,"xPts":4.57,"fixtures":["LEE(H) FDR3"]}
 ],
 "whySelected": [
  "7 goals and 0 assists this season (xGI 5.2).",
  "Strong underlying attacking numbers: 0.62 xGI per 90.",
  "Regular starter with secure minutes.",
  "MUN (home) concede 1.71 goals/game vs league 1.36.",
  "Projects 5.5 pts, #2 of 79 FWDs this gameweek."
 ],
 "warnings": []
},
{
 "id": 572,
 "name": "Tzolakis",
 "fullName": "Konstantinos Tzolakis",
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 "club": "HUL",
 "position": "GKP",
 "role": "bench",
 "slot": 12,
 "benchOrder": 1,
 "isCaptain": false,
 "isViceCaptain": false,
 "priceM": 4.7,
 "ownershipPct": 13.5,
 "status": "a",
 "news": null,
 "season": {
  "minutes": 900,
  "starts": 10,
  "goals": 0,
  "assists": 0,
  "xG": 0,
  "xA": 0,
  "xGI": 0,
  "xGI_per90": 0,
  "cleanSheets": 3,
  "saves": 41,
  "bonus": 7,
  "defensiveContributionPer90": 0,
  "totalPoints": 49,
  "pointsPerGame": 4.9,
  "form": 3.2
 },
 "projection": {
  "gw": 11,
  "xPts": 3.58,
  "confidence": "high",
  "confidenceScore": 0.85,
  "startProbability": 1,
  "availability": 1,
  "expectedMinutes": 80,
  "fixtures": [{"opponent":"BHA","home":true,"fdr":4,"kickoff":"2026-11-22T14:00:00Z"}],
  "breakdown": {
   "appearance": 1.93,
   "goals": 0,
   "assists": 0,
   "cleanSheet": 0.85,
   "goalsConceded": -0.47,
   "saves": 0.93,
   "defContrib": 0,
   "bonus": 0.48,
   "cards": -0.07,
   "formAdj": -0.08
  }
 },
 "upcomingFiveGws": [
  {"gw":11,"xPts":3.58,"fixtures":["BHA(H) FDR4"]},
  {"gw":12,"xPts":3.59,"fixtures":["CRY(A) FDR2"]},
  {"gw":13,"xPts":3.77,"fixtures":["NFO(H) FDR3"]},
  {"gw":14,"xPts":3.38,"fixtures":["BOU(A) FDR4"]},
  {"gw":15,"xPts":3.8,"fixtures":["TOT(H) FDR3"]}
 ],
 "whySelected": ["3 clean sheets and 41 saves this season.","Regular starter with secure minutes.","Projects 3.6 pts, #2 of 75 GKPs this gameweek."],
 "warnings": ["Difficult fixture: BHA (home), FDR 4."]
},
{
 "id": 124,
 "name": "Groß",
 "fullName": "Pascal Groß",
 "club": "BHA",
 "position": "MID",
 "role": "bench",
 "slot": 13,
 "benchOrder": 2,
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 "isCaptain": false,
 "isViceCaptain": false,
 "priceM": 6.3,
 "ownershipPct": 48.1,
 "status": "a",
 "news": null,
 "season": {
  "minutes": 880,
  "starts": 10,
  "goals": 4,
  "assists": 6,
  "xG": 3.03,
  "xA": 2.22,
  "xGI": 5.25,
  "xGI_per90": 0.54,
  "cleanSheets": 7,
  "saves": 0,
  "bonus": 11,
  "defensiveContributionPer90": 5.83,
  "totalPoints": 70,
  "pointsPerGame": 7,
  "form": 4.2
 },
 "projection": {
  "gw": 11,
  "xPts": 4.15,
  "confidence": "high",
  "confidenceScore": 0.84,
  "startProbability": 0.99,
  "availability": 1,
  "expectedMinutes": 80,
  "fixtures": [{"opponent":"HUL","home":false,"fdr":2,"kickoff":"2026-11-22T14:00:00Z"}],
  "breakdown": {
   "appearance": 1.92,
   "goals": 1.05,
   "assists": 0.56,
   "cleanSheet": 0.26,
   "goalsConceded": 0,
   "saves": 0,
   "defContrib": 0.07,
   "bonus": 0.7,
   "cards": -0.31,
   "formAdj": -0.11
  }
 },
 "upcomingFiveGws": [
  {"gw":11,"xPts":4.15,"fixtures":["HUL(A) FDR2"]},
  {"gw":12,"xPts":4.96,"fixtures":["NEW(H) FDR3"]},
  {"gw":13,"xPts":4.08,"fixtures":["BOU(A) FDR4"]},
  {"gw":14,"xPts":4.06,"fixtures":["NFO(A) FDR2"]},
  {"gw":15,"xPts":4.53,"fixtures":["EVE(H) FDR3"]}
 ],
 "whySelected": [
  "4 goals and 6 assists this season (xGI 5.3).",
  "Strong underlying attacking numbers: 0.54 xGI per 90.",
  "First-choice penalty taker.",
  "Regular starter with secure minutes.",
  "Favourable fixture: HUL (away), FDR 2.",
  "Projects 4.2 pts, #7 of 299 MIDs this gameweek."
 ],
 "warnings": []
},
{
 "id": 334,
 "name": "Muharemović",
 "fullName": "Tarik Muharemović",
 "club": "LEE",
 "position": "DEF",
 "role": "bench",
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 "slot": 14,
 "benchOrder": 3,
 "isCaptain": false,
 "isViceCaptain": false,
 "priceM": 5.1,
 "ownershipPct": 6.4,
 "status": "a",
 "news": null,
 "season": {
  "minutes": 900,
  "starts": 10,
  "goals": 0,
  "assists": 2,
  "xG": 0.65,
  "xA": 0.24,
  "xGI": 0.89,
  "xGI_per90": 0.08,
  "cleanSheets": 4,
  "saves": 0,
  "bonus": 3,
  "defensiveContributionPer90": 11.2,
  "totalPoints": 56,
  "pointsPerGame": 5.6,
  "form": 6.8
 },
 "projection": {
  "gw": 11,
  "xPts": 3.8,
  "confidence": "high",
  "confidenceScore": 0.85,
  "startProbability": 1,
  "availability": 1,
  "expectedMinutes": 80,
  "fixtures": [{"opponent":"CHE","home":false,"fdr":4,"kickoff":"2026-11-21T15:00:00Z"}],
  "breakdown": {
   "appearance": 1.93,
   "goals": 0.28,
   "assists": 0.16,
   "cleanSheet": 0.85,
   "goalsConceded": -0.47,
   "saves": 0,
   "defContrib": 0.88,
   "bonus": 0.24,
   "cards": -0.12,
   "formAdj": 0.05
  }
 },
 "upcomingFiveGws": [
  {"gw":11,"xPts":3.8,"fixtures":["CHE(A) FDR4"]},
  {"gw":12,"xPts":4.68,"fixtures":["COV(H) FDR2"]},
  {"gw":13,"xPts":3.57,"fixtures":["MCI(A) FDR5"]},
  {"gw":14,"xPts":4.53,"fixtures":["IPS(H) FDR2"]},
  {"gw":15,"xPts":3.78,"fixtures":["LIV(A) FDR4"]}
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 "whySelected": [
  "0 goals and 2 assists this season (xGI 0.9).",
  "Defensive returns: 4 clean sheets.",
  "Regularly reaches the defensive-contribution threshold.",
  "Regular starter with secure minutes.",
  "Projects 3.8 pts, #8 of 219 DEFs this gameweek."
 ],
 "warnings": ["Difficult fixture: CHE (away), FDR 4."]
},
{
 "id": 566,
 "name": "Silva",
 "fullName": "António João Pereira de Albuquerque Tavares da Silva",
 "club": "BOU",
 "position": "DEF",
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  "role": "bench",
  "slot": 15,
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  "isCaptain": false,
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  "priceM": 5.1,
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  "news": null,
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   "starts": 10,
   "goals": 0,
   "assists": 0,
   "xG": 1.3,
   "xA": 0.37,
   "xGI": 1.67,
   "xGI_per90": 0.17,
   "cleanSheets": 3,
   "saves": 0,
   "bonus": 3,
   "defensiveContributionPer90": 10.6,
   "totalPoints": 40,
   "pointsPerGame": 4,
   "form": 6.8
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  "projection": {
   "gw": 11,
   "xPts": 4.28,
   "confidence": "high",
   "confidenceScore": 0.85,
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   "availability": 1,
   "expectedMinutes": 80,
   "fixtures": [{"opponent":"NFO","home":true,"fdr":3,"kickoff":"2026-11-21T15:00:00Z"}],
   "breakdown": {
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    "goals": 0.48,
    "assists": 0.11,
    "cleanSheet": 1.15,
    "goalsConceded": -0.33,
    "saves": 0,
    "defContrib": 0.81,
    "bonus": 0.24,
    "cards": -0.3,
    "formAdj": 0.2
   }
  },
  "upcomingFiveGws": [
   {"gw":11,"xPts":4.28,"fixtures":["NFO(H) FDR3"]},
   {"gw":12,"xPts":3.79,"fixtures":["FUL(A) FDR3"]},
   {"gw":13,"xPts":3.77,"fixtures":["BHA(H) FDR4"]},
   {"gw":14,"xPts":4.44,"fixtures":["HUL(H) FDR2"]},
   {"gw":15,"xPts":3.42,"fixtures":["ARS(A) FDR5"]}
  ],
  "whySelected": ["Regularly reaches the defensive-contribution threshold.","Regular starter with secure minutes.","Projects 4.3 pts, #4 of 219 DEFs this gameweek."],
  "warnings": []
 }
],
"userEditsVsGeneratedSquad": null,
"season": null,
"transferRecommendations": {
 "note": "Team Builder generates a new squad, so there are no transfers to recommend. Below: the best legal replacements for each player within budget, by expected points.",
 "replacementShortlist": {
  "Ødegaard": [
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   {"player":"McGinn","xPts":4.21,"priceM":5.4,"squadPointsChange":-0.04},
   {"player":"Dewsbury-Hall","xPts":3.78,"priceM":6.7,"squadPointsChange":-0.15}
  ],
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 {"player":"McGinn","xPts":4.21,"priceM":5.4,"squadPointsChange":-0.71},
 {"player":"Dewsbury-Hall","xPts":3.78,"priceM":6.7,"squadPointsChange":-0.82}
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"Van Hecke": [
 {"player":"Jacquet","xPts":3.81,"priceM":5.1,"squadPointsChange":-0.82},
 {"player":"Ajer","xPts":3.76,"priceM":4.5,"squadPointsChange":-0.82},
 {"player":"Konsa","xPts":3.61,"priceM":4.8,"squadPointsChange":-0.82}
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 {"player":"Jacquet","xPts":3.81,"priceM":5.1,"squadPointsChange":0},
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"Groß": [
 {"player":"Rudoni","xPts":4.47,"priceM":4.9,"squadPointsChange":0.32},
 {"player":"McGinn","xPts":4.21,"priceM":5.4,"squadPointsChange":0.06},
 {"player":"Lewis-Potter","xPts":3.76,"priceM":5.5,"squadPointsChange":-0.05}
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"Barry": [
 {"player":"Emersonn","xPts":3.38,"priceM":5.4,"squadPointsChange":-0.55},
 {"player":"McBurnie","xPts":3.36,"priceM":5.5,"squadPointsChange":-0.55},
 {"player":"Delap","xPts":3.04,"priceM":5.3,"squadPointsChange":-0.55}
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 {"player":"Jacquet","xPts":3.81,"priceM":5.1,"squadPointsChange":0},
 {"player":"Ajer","xPts":3.76,"priceM":4.5,"squadPointsChange":0},
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 {"player":"Evanilson","xPts":4.81,"priceM":6.5,"squadPointsChange":-0.69},
 {"player":"Calvert-Lewin","xPts":3.88,"priceM":6,"squadPointsChange":-1.4}
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 {"player":"Kinsky","xPts":3.36,"priceM":4.4,"squadPointsChange":-0.29},
 {"player":"Kelleher","xPts":3.34,"priceM":5,"squadPointsChange":-0.29},
 {"player":"Suzuki","xPts":3.27,"priceM":5,"squadPointsChange":-0.29}
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"Haaland": [
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 {"player":"Calvert-Lewin","xPts":3.88,"priceM":6,"squadPointsChange":-1.44}
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"Mbeumo": [
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 {"player":"Wirtz","xPts":4.24,"priceM":7.2,"squadPointsChange":0.09},
 {"player":"McGinn","xPts":4.21,"priceM":5.4,"squadPointsChange":0.06}
],
"Vuskovic": [
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 {"player":"Ajer","xPts":3.76,"priceM":4.5,"squadPointsChange":-0.02},
 {"player":"Truffert","xPts":3.75,"priceM":5.4,"squadPointsChange":-0.02}
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"E.Le Fée": [
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 {"player":"McGinn","xPts":4.21,"priceM":5.4,"squadPointsChange":-0.19},
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"Silva": [
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 {"player":"Ajer","xPts":3.76,"priceM":4.5,"squadPointsChange":-0.18},
 {"player":"Konsa","xPts":3.61,"priceM":4.8,"squadPointsChange":-0.18}
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"Tzolakis": [
 {"player":"Kinsky","xPts":3.36,"priceM":4.4,"squadPointsChange":0},
 {"player":"Petrović","xPts":3.19,"priceM":4.5,"squadPointsChange":0},
 {"player":"Rushworth","xPts":3.17,"priceM":4.5,"squadPointsChange":0}
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 "chipStrategy": null,
 "model": {
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a bounded form tilt. Goal/assist rates blend 0.8*xG/xA + 0.2*actual, shrunk to the positional average by minutes (reliability = minutes/(minutes+450)). Fixture strength uses opponents' goals and xG for/
against with home advantage. Squads come from an integer-linear-programming optimiser (not an LLM).",
  "confidence": "confidenceScore = 0.45*sample size + 0.25*availability certainty + 0.30*start probability; high >= 0.7, medium >= 0.45, else low.",
  "backtest": {
   "gameweeks": "GW5-GW10",
   "sample": 1338,
   "modelMae": 2.3,
   "baselineMae": 2.57,
   "modelBias": 0.05,
   "captainAvgPoints": 5.33,
   "baselineCaptainAvgPoints": 2.67,
   "caveat": "Small sample (6 gameweeks); availability news is not point-in-time in the backtest."
  },
  "limitations": [
   "xPts are estimates; the model has no access to team news beyond FPL's status/news fields.",
   "No shots-on-target or box-touch data; opponent xGC is derived from the first-choice goalkeeper.",
   "Future prices are not predicted; selling prices use today's prices.",
   "Small backtest sample; weights are heuristics, not fitted."
  ]
 },
 "reviewerGuide": [
  "Check the captain/vice choice against fixtures and minutes security.",
  "Check each starter's start probability and any warnings, especially flagged players.",
  "Sanity-check xPts breakdowns (appearance, goals, assists, clean sheet, bonus) for implausible values.",
  "Challenge the transfer decision (save vs move vs hit) and the chip verdicts using the next-five-gameweek fixtures.",
  "Look for club-concentration, bench-quality and budget-use issues."
 ],
 "strategy": {
  "name": "Balanced Plus",
  "summary": "A fourth strategy next to Balanced, Safe and Aggressive: a diversified, minutes-secure squad judged over five gameweeks, built on underlying xG/xA rather than recent form.",
  "rules": [
   "At most 2 players from any one club in the starting XI (the squad still obeys the FPL limit of 3).",
   "XI players must be secure starters: start probability >= 75%, >= 60 expected minutes, availability >= 90%.",
   "Objective value = discounted xPts over the next five gameweeks (weights 1 / 0.9 / 0.8 / 0.7 / 0.6), scaled by minutes security (0.6 + 0.2 x start probability + 0.2 x min(1, expected minutes /
80)).",
   "Inside the objective, the player's own goal and assist terms are rebuilt from xG and xA only (realised goals and assists are excluded from those two terms). Bonus points, defensive contribution,
saves, cards, team goals conceded and minutes/starts still come from realised data, exactly as in the shared projection model.",
   "The recent-form tilt is removed from the objective. It is NOT removed from the displayed xPts or breakdown, and captaincy is chosen from the displayed xPts, so form can still influence the
armband.",
   "Strong playable bench: every outfield sub must have >= 50% start probability, the bench counts for 25% of a starter's value (Balanced: 12%), and the four bench players must total >= 12 xPts when
feasible.",
   "Captain = highest displayed (raw model) xPts in the XI, chosen independently of the squad objective. Vice = best remaining secure starter (>= 85% start) from a different club to the captain.",
   "Same FPL data snapshot and same £100m budget as the other three strategies."
  ],
  "methodology": {
   "objectiveVersusDisplayedXpts": "Two different numbers exist for every player. DISPLAYED xPts (tables, breakdown, captaincy, comparison metrics) come from the shared projection engine used by all
four strategies. The Balanced Plus OBJECTIVE VALUE (what the solver maximises) is a separate five-gameweek quantity derived from it. The per-player table in this report shows both.",
   "realisedDataInDisplayedXpts": "goals and assists: 80% xG/xA + 20% realised; bonus, saves, defensive contribution and cards: realised per-90 rates; clean sheets and goals conceded: team goals
against (50% realised) and xGA; minutes and starts: realised; positional priors include realised totals.",
   "realisedDataInObjective": "Excluded: the player's own realised goals and assists. Still included: bonus, defensive contribution, saves, cards, team goals conceded, minutes and starts.",
   "form": "Removed from the objective only. Present in displayed xPts (mean absolute size about 0.03 xPts per player; up to ~0.3) and therefore in captaincy.",
   "minutesSecurity": "Applied on top of a projection that already scales by expected minutes, so minutes are deliberately counted twice."
  },
  "parameters": {
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   "maxPerClubXI": 2,
   "xiMinStartProb": 0.75,
   "xiMinExpMinutes": 60,
   "xiMinAvailability": 0.9,
   "benchMinStartProb": 0.5,
   "minAvailability": 0.75,
   "benchWeight": 0.25,
   "benchTargets": [12,11,10,9,8,6,0],
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 "viceMinStartProb": 0.85,
 "viceMinAvailability": 0.9
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  "objectiveValueGw": 3.84,
  "displayedXpts5Gw": 4.05,
  "objectiveValue5Gw": 4.02,
  "formXptsRemoved5Gw": 0.03,
  "xgxaRebuild5Gw": 0,
  "startProb": 1
 },
 {
  "name": "Van Hecke",
  "displayedXptsGw": 4.92,
  "objectiveValueGw": 4.82,
  "displayedXpts5Gw": 4.45,
  "objectiveValue5Gw": 4.36,
  "formXptsRemoved5Gw": 0.1,
  "xgxaRebuild5Gw": 0,
  "startProb": 1
 },
 {
  "name": "De Cuyper",
  "displayedXptsGw": 4.1,
  "objectiveValueGw": 4.08,
  "displayedXpts5Gw": 4.26,
  "objectiveValue5Gw": 4.24,
  "formXptsRemoved5Gw": -0.08,
  "xgxaRebuild5Gw": -0.06,
  "startProb": 0.97
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 {
  "name": "Vuskovic",
  "displayedXptsGw": 4.12,
  "objectiveValueGw": 4.06,
  "displayedXpts5Gw": 4.21,
  "objectiveValue5Gw": 4.15,
  "formXptsRemoved5Gw": 0.02,
  "xgxaRebuild5Gw": -0.04,
  "startProb": 1
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 {
  "name": "Tavernier",
  "displayedXptsGw": 4.92,
  "objectiveValueGw": 4.85,
  "displayedXpts5Gw": 4.63,
  "objectiveValue5Gw": 4.57,
  "formXptsRemoved5Gw": 0.04,
  "xgxaRebuild5Gw": 0,
  "startProb": 0.98
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 {
  "name": "Mbeumo",
  "displayedXptsGw": 3.78,
  "objectiveValueGw": 3.88,
  "displayedXpts5Gw": 4.3,
  "objectiveValue5Gw": 4.43,
  "formXptsRemoved5Gw": -0.08,
  "xgxaRebuild5Gw": 0.05,
  "startProb": 1
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  "name": "E.Le Fée",
  "displayedXptsGw": 4.4,
  "objectiveValueGw": 4.36,
  "displayedXpts5Gw": 4.34,
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 "objectiveValue5Gw": 4.3,
 "formXptsRemoved5Gw": 0.1,
 "xgxaRebuild5Gw": 0.08,
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 "name": "Ødegaard",
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 "objectiveValueGw": 4.26,
 "displayedXpts5Gw": 4.18,
 "objectiveValue5Gw": 4.19,
 "formXptsRemoved5Gw": 0,
 "xgxaRebuild5Gw": 0.05,
 "startProb": 0.97
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 "name": "Haaland",
 "displayedXptsGw": 5.52,
 "objectiveValueGw": 5.49,
 "displayedXpts5Gw": 5.1,
 "objectiveValue5Gw": 5.08,
 "formXptsRemoved5Gw": -0.04,
 "xgxaRebuild5Gw": -0.06,
 "startProb": 1
},
{
 "name": "Barry",
 "displayedXptsGw": 4.65,
 "objectiveValueGw": 4.58,
 "displayedXpts5Gw": 4.87,
 "objectiveValue5Gw": 4.79,
 "formXptsRemoved5Gw": 0.09,
 "xgxaRebuild5Gw": 0.04,
 "startProb": 0.98
},
{
 "name": "Isak",
 "displayedXptsGw": 5.5,
 "objectiveValueGw": 5.13,
 "displayedXpts5Gw": 4.91,
 "objectiveValue5Gw": 4.59,
 "formXptsRemoved5Gw": 0.01,
 "xgxaRebuild5Gw": -0.1,
 "startProb": 0.88
},
{
 "name": "Tzolakis",
 "displayedXptsGw": 3.58,
 "objectiveValueGw": 3.66,
 "displayedXpts5Gw": 3.62,
 "objectiveValue5Gw": 3.7,
 "formXptsRemoved5Gw": -0.08,
 "xgxaRebuild5Gw": 0,
 "startProb": 1
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{
 "name": "Groß",
 "displayedXptsGw": 4.15,
 "objectiveValueGw": 4.08,
 "displayedXpts5Gw": 4.36,
 "objectiveValue5Gw": 4.28,
 "formXptsRemoved5Gw": -0.11,
 "xgxaRebuild5Gw": -0.19,
 "startProb": 0.99
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 "name": "Muharemović",
 "displayedXptsGw": 3.8,
 "objectiveValueGw": 3.73,
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    "startProb": 1
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   {
    "name": "Silva",
    "displayedXptsGw": 4.28,
    "objectiveValueGw": 4.19,
    "displayedXpts5Gw": 3.97,
    "objectiveValue5Gw": 3.88,
    "formXptsRemoved5Gw": 0.18,
    "xgxaRebuild5Gw": 0.1,
    "startProb": 1
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  ],
  "historicalValidation": {
   "available": true,
   "verdict": "no-advantage-established",
   "verdictText": "Balanced Plus is competitive, but no advantage over Balanced is established.",
   "headline": "Balanced Plus is competitive, but no advantage over Balanced is established. (58 held-out windows)",
   "lines": [
    "Held-out seasons 2024-25 and 2025-26: 58 rolling five-gameweek windows (12 non-overlapping).",
    "Balanced Plus minus Balanced: mean +5.6 points per window (median -1.5, SD 33.6); 95% CI -19.7 to +26.0 (t, non-overlapping) and -2.1 to +15.3 (block bootstrap).",
    "By season: 2024-25 +15.9, 2025-26 -4.6. Development season 2023-24: +19.8 (not used as evidence)."
   ],
   "limitations": [
    "Only two held-out seasons (12 independent five-gameweek windows): differences smaller than about 6 points per gameweek cannot be detected.",
    "No point-in-time injury or availability news exists; a past-minutes proxy is used for every strategy.",
    "One squad is held for five gameweeks (no transfers, chips or price changes), so season-long play is not tested.",
    "Fixtures are the final schedule and prices are up to a week stale; the source is a third-party scrape assumed accurate.",
    "2022-23 was excluded (the source lacks starts and xG for the first gameweeks); 2026-27 has too few gameweeks.",
    "The strategy's parameters were not tuned on any window, but its ideas were designed with prior FPL knowledge; sensitivity results are exploratory."
   ]
  }
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 "strategyComparison": {
  "note": "Balanced, Safe and Aggressive come from the unchanged optimiser. Every changed player has an explanation.",
  "captaincy": {
   "ranking": [
    {"name":"Haaland","xPts":5.52,"startProbability":1},
    {"name":"Isak","xPts":5.5,"startProbability":0.88},
    {"name":"Van Hecke","xPts":4.92,"startProbability":1},
    {"name":"Tavernier","xPts":4.92,"startProbability":0.98},
    {"name":"Barry","xPts":4.65,"startProbability":0.98}
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   "viceRule": "best remaining secure starter (start >= 85%) from a different club to the captain"
  },
  "bench": {"totalXpts":15.81,"targetMet":12},
  "gw": 11,
  "metrics": [
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    "key": "balanced",
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    "formation": "4-3-3",
    "costM": 99.8,
    "bankM": 0.2,
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    "fiveGwXpts": 276.19,
    "fiveGwDiscounted": 221.13,
    "perGw": [57.14,53.84,53.58,56.93,54.7],
    "maxClubInXI": 3,
    "clubsOverTwoInXI": ["BOU x3"],
    "benchXpts": 15.84,
    "benchAvgStartProb": 0.96,
    "xiAvgStartProb": 0.96,
    "xiMinStartProb": 0.87,
    "xiAvgExpMinutes": 77,
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 "xiAssistShareOfXgi": 0.23,
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 "captain": {"id":411,"name":"Haaland","xpts":5.52,"startProb":1},
 "vice": {"id":379,"name":"Isak","xpts":5.5,"startProb":0.88,"sameClubAsCaptain":false}
},
{
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 "label": "Safe",
 "formation": "4-3-3",
 "costM": 100,
 "bankM": 0,
 "gw0Xpts": 56.67,
 "fiveGwXpts": 275.92,
 "fiveGwDiscounted": 220.97,
 "perGw": [56.67,54.6,54.22,55.27,55.16],
 "maxClubInXI": 3,
 "clubsOverTwoInXI": ["BOU x3"],
 "benchXpts": 16.32,
 "benchAvgStartProb": 0.95,
 "xiAvgStartProb": 0.98,
 "xiMinStartProb": 0.88,
 "xiAvgExpMinutes": 79,
 "xiBelowSecurityBar": [],
 "xiXgi90Outfield": 4.68,
 "xiAssistShareOfXgi": 0.22,
 "xiFormTiltXpts": 0.86,
 "avgConfidence": 0.83,
 "captain": {"id":411,"name":"Haaland","xpts":5.52,"startProb":1},
 "vice": {"id":379,"name":"Isak","xpts":5.5,"startProb":0.88,"sameClubAsCaptain":false}
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 "label": "Aggressive",
 "formation": "3-4-3",
 "costM": 96.8,
 "bankM": 3.2,
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 "fiveGwXpts": 271.98,
 "fiveGwDiscounted": 218.02,
 "perGw": [56.74,52.59,53.97,55.68,53],
 "maxClubInXI": 3,
 "clubsOverTwoInXI": ["BOU x3"],
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 "benchAvgStartProb": 0.96,
 "xiAvgStartProb": 0.97,
 "xiMinStartProb": 0.87,
 "xiAvgExpMinutes": 78,
 "xiBelowSecurityBar": [],
 "xiXgi90Outfield": 4.81,
 "xiAssistShareOfXgi": 0.22,
 "xiFormTiltXpts": 0.88,
 "avgConfidence": 0.82,
 "captain": {"id":411,"name":"Haaland","xpts":5.52,"startProb":1},
 "vice": {"id":379,"name":"Isak","xpts":5.5,"startProb":0.88,"sameClubAsCaptain":false}
},
{
 "key": "balanced-plus",
 "label": "Balanced Plus",
 "formation": "3-4-3",
 "costM": 99.9,
 "bankM": 0.1,
 "gw0Xpts": 55.55,
 "fiveGwXpts": 276.6,
 "fiveGwDiscounted": 221.2,
 "perGw": [55.55,55.71,53.68,55.7,55.96],
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    "clubsOverTwoInXI": [],
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    "xiMinStartProb": 0.88,
    "xiAvgExpMinutes": 79,
    "xiBelowSecurityBar": [],
    "xiXgi90Outfield": 5.39,
    "xiAssistShareOfXgi": 0.22,
    "xiFormTiltXpts": 0.21,
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    "captain": {"id":411,"name":"Haaland","xpts":5.52,"startProb":1},
    "vice": {"id":379,"name":"Isak","xpts":5.5,"startProb":0.88,"sameClubAsCaptain":false}
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    "againstLabel": "Balanced",
    "overlap": 9,
    "changedPlayers": 6,
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      "to": "XI",
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      "to": "bench",
      "explanation": "Silva moves from XI to bench. Balanced started 3 BOU players; Balanced Plus keeps at most 2 in the XI and Silva is not among its top 2 by value for this gameweek. Five-gameweek
value 3.88 ranks below the players Balanced Plus starts."
     }
    ],
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      "whyOut": ["Lower five-gameweek value: 3.22 vs 3.70 for Tzolakis."],
      "whyIn": ["Fit substitute keeper: 100% start probability, 100% available.","Five-gameweek value 3.70 (raw model 3.62); next-five fixture difficulty 3.2."],
      "explanation": "Kinsky (TOT, £4.4m, bench in Balanced) -> Tzolakis (HUL, £4.7m, bench in Balanced Plus). GW11 xPts 3.36 -> 3.58; five-GW value 3.22 -> 3.70. Out: Lower five-gameweek value: 3.22
vs 3.70 for Tzolakis. In: Fit substitute keeper: 100% start probability, 100% available. Five-gameweek value 3.70 (raw model 3.62); next-five fixture difficulty 3.2."
     },
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      "whyOut": [
       "Squad-level trade-off: De Cuyper is not individually better (five-gameweek value 4.24 vs 4.26); the optimiser chose the combination with the highest total five-gameweek value under the XI club
cap, the bench target and £100m.",
       "Price: Gabriel £8.1m vs De Cuyper £5.5m (£2.6m cheaper with Balanced Plus)."
      ],
      "whyIn": [
       "Secure starter: 97% start probability, ~78 expected minutes.",
       "Underlying attack: xGI/90 0.43 (xG 2.4, xA 1.5), not just returns (2G 4A).",
       "Five-gameweek value 4.24 (raw model 4.26); next-five fixture difficulty 2.8.",
       "Keeps BHA at 2 in the XI (limit 2)."
      ],
      "explanation": "Gabriel (ARS, £8.1m, XI in Balanced) -> De Cuyper (BHA, £5.5m, XI in Balanced Plus). GW11 xPts 4.39 -> 4.10; five-GW value 4.26 -> 4.24. Out: Squad-level trade-off: De Cuyper is
not individually better (five-gameweek value 4.24 vs 4.26); the optimiser chose the combination with the highest total five-gameweek value under the XI club cap, the bench target and £100m. Price:
Gabriel £8.1m vs De Cuyper £5.5m (£2.6m cheaper with Balanced Plus). In: Secure starter: 97% start probability, ~78 expected minutes. Underlying attack: xGI/90 0.43 (xG 2.4, xA 1.5), not just returns
(2G 4A). Five-gameweek value 4.24 (raw model 4.26); next-five fixture difficulty 2.8. Keeps BHA at 2 in the XI (limit 2)."
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       "0.17 xPts (5-GW average) of the projection came from the recent-form tilt, which Balanced Plus removes.",
       "Price: Hill £5.6m vs Muharemović £5.1m (£0.5m cheaper with Balanced Plus)."
      ],
      "whyIn": [
       "Playable bench option: 100% start probability, 100% available.",
       "Underlying attack: xGI/90 0.08 (xG 0.7, xA 0.2), not just returns (0G 2A).",
       "Five-gameweek value 4.00 (raw model 4.08); next-five fixture difficulty 3.4."
      ],
      "explanation": "Hill (BOU, £5.6m, XI in Balanced) -> Muharemović (LEE, £5.1m, bench in Balanced Plus). GW11 xPts 4.45 -> 3.80; five-GW value 4.03 -> 4.00. Out: Balanced started 3 BOU players
(Hill, Silva, Tavernier); Balanced Plus allows at most 2 per club in the XI. 0.17 xPts (5-GW average) of the projection came from the recent-form tilt, which Balanced Plus removes. Price: Hill £5.6m vs
Muharemović £5.1m (£0.5m cheaper with Balanced Plus). In: Playable bench option: 100% start probability, 100% available. Underlying attack: xGI/90 0.08 (xG 0.7, xA 0.2), not just returns (0G 2A). Five-
gameweek value 4.00 (raw model 4.08); next-five fixture difficulty 3.4."
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      "in": {"id":427,"name":"Mbeumo","club":"MUN","priceM":7.9,"role":"XI","gw0Xpts":3.78,"fiveGwValue":4.43},
      "whyOut": ["Lower five-gameweek value: 3.69 vs 4.43 for Mbeumo.","Price: Rudoni £4.9m vs Mbeumo £7.9m (£3.0m dearer with Balanced Plus)."],
      "whyIn": [
       "Secure starter: 100% start probability, ~80 expected minutes.",
       "Underlying attack: xGI/90 0.60 (xG 4.6, xA 1.3), not just returns (4G 1A).",
       "Five-gameweek value 4.43 (raw model 4.30); next-five fixture difficulty 2.8.",
       "Keeps MUN at 1 in the XI (limit 2)."
      ],
      "explanation": "Rudoni (COV, £4.9m, XI in Balanced) -> Mbeumo (MUN, £7.9m, XI in Balanced Plus). GW11 xPts 4.47 -> 3.78; five-GW value 3.69 -> 4.43. Out: Lower five-gameweek value: 3.69 vs 4.43
for Mbeumo. Price: Rudoni £4.9m vs Mbeumo £7.9m (£3.0m dearer with Balanced Plus). In: Secure starter: 100% start probability, ~80 expected minutes. Underlying attack: xGI/90 0.60 (xG 4.6, xA 1.3), not
just returns (4G 1A). Five-gameweek value 4.43 (raw model 4.30); next-five fixture difficulty 2.8. Keeps MUN at 1 in the XI (limit 2)."
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      "in": {"id":15,"name":"Ødegaard","club":"ARS","priceM":6.7,"role":"XI","gw0Xpts":4.25,"fiveGwValue":4.19},
      "whyOut": ["Lower five-gameweek value: 3.93 vs 4.19 for Ødegaard.","Price: McGinn £5.4m vs Ødegaard £6.7m (£1.3m dearer with Balanced Plus)."],
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       "Underlying attack: xGI/90 0.53 (xG 2.4, xA 2.5), not just returns (3G 0A).",
       "Five-gameweek value 4.19 (raw model 4.18); next-five fixture difficulty 3.4.",
       "Keeps ARS at 1 in the XI (limit 2)."
      ],
      "explanation": "McGinn (AVL, £5.4m, bench in Balanced) -> Ødegaard (ARS, £6.7m, XI in Balanced Plus). GW11 xPts 4.21 -> 4.25; five-GW value 3.93 -> 4.19. Out: Lower five-gameweek value: 3.93 vs
4.19 for Ødegaard. Price: McGinn £5.4m vs Ødegaard £6.7m (£1.3m dearer with Balanced Plus). In: Secure starter: 97% start probability, ~78 expected minutes. Underlying attack: xGI/90 0.53 (xG 2.4, xA
2.5), not just returns (3G 0A). Five-gameweek value 4.19 (raw model 4.18); next-five fixture difficulty 3.4. Keeps ARS at 1 in the XI (limit 2)."
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      "whyOut": [
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       "Realised returns (6G 1A) outrun underlying numbers (xG 3.5, xA 0.9); rebuilt on xG/xA the value drops 0.15.",
       "Lower five-gameweek value: 4.31 vs 4.79 for Barry.",
       "Price: N.Jackson £7.1m vs Barry £5.7m (£1.4m cheaper with Balanced Plus)."
      ],
      "whyIn": [
       "Secure starter: 98% start probability, ~79 expected minutes.",
       "Underlying attack: xGI/90 0.82 (xG 7.3, xA 0.5), not just returns (6G 1A).",
       "Five-gameweek value 4.79 (raw model 4.87); next-five fixture difficulty 3.4.",
       "Keeps EVE at 1 in the XI (limit 2)."
      ],
      "explanation": "N.Jackson (AVL, £7.1m, XI in Balanced) -> Barry (EVE, £5.7m, XI in Balanced Plus). GW11 xPts 4.90 -> 4.65; five-GW value 4.31 -> 4.79. Out: 0.15 xPts (5-GW average) of the
projection came from the recent-form tilt, which Balanced Plus removes. Realised returns (6G 1A) outrun underlying numbers (xG 3.5, xA 0.9); rebuilt on xG/xA the value drops 0.15. Lower five-gameweek
value: 4.31 vs 4.79 for Barry. Price: N.Jackson £7.1m vs Barry £5.7m (£1.4m cheaper with Balanced Plus). In: Secure starter: 98% start probability, ~79 expected minutes. Underlying attack: xGI/90 0.82
(xG 7.3, xA 0.5), not just returns (6G 1A). Five-gameweek value 4.79 (raw model 4.87); next-five fixture difficulty 3.4. Keeps EVE at 1 in the XI (limit 2)."
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      "to": "bench",
      "explanation": "Silva moves from XI to bench. Safe started 3 BOU players; Balanced Plus keeps at most 2 in the XI and Silva is not among its top 2 by value for this gameweek. Five-gameweek value
3.88 ranks below the players Balanced Plus starts."
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      "whyOut": [
       "Squad-level trade-off: De Cuyper is not individually better (five-gameweek value 4.24 vs 4.26); the optimiser chose the combination with the highest total five-gameweek value under the XI club
cap, the bench target and £100m.",
       "Price: Gabriel £8.1m vs De Cuyper £5.5m (£2.6m cheaper with Balanced Plus)."
      ],
      "whyIn": [
       "Secure starter: 97% start probability, ~78 expected minutes.",
       "Underlying attack: xGI/90 0.43 (xG 2.4, xA 1.5), not just returns (2G 4A).",
       "Five-gameweek value 4.24 (raw model 4.26); next-five fixture difficulty 2.8.",
       "Keeps BHA at 2 in the XI (limit 2)."
      ],
      "explanation": "Gabriel (ARS, £8.1m, XI in Safe) -> De Cuyper (BHA, £5.5m, XI in Balanced Plus). GW11 xPts 4.39 -> 4.10; five-GW value 4.26 -> 4.24. Out: Squad-level trade-off: De Cuyper is not
individually better (five-gameweek value 4.24 vs 4.26); the optimiser chose the combination with the highest total five-gameweek value under the XI club cap, the bench target and £100m. Price: Gabriel
£8.1m vs De Cuyper £5.5m (£2.6m cheaper with Balanced Plus). In: Secure starter: 97% start probability, ~78 expected minutes. Underlying attack: xGI/90 0.43 (xG 2.4, xA 1.5), not just returns (2G 4A).
Five-gameweek value 4.24 (raw model 4.26); next-five fixture difficulty 2.8. Keeps BHA at 2 in the XI (limit 2)."
     },
     {
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      "in": {"id":334,"name":"Muharemović","club":"LEE","priceM":5.1,"role":"bench","gw0Xpts":3.8,"fiveGwValue":4},
      "whyOut": [
       "Safe started 3 BOU players (Hill, Silva, Tavernier); Balanced Plus allows at most 2 per club in the XI.",
       "0.17 xPts (5-GW average) of the projection came from the recent-form tilt, which Balanced Plus removes.",
       "Price: Hill £5.6m vs Muharemović £5.1m (£0.5m cheaper with Balanced Plus)."
      ],
      "whyIn": [
       "Playable bench option: 100% start probability, 100% available.",
       "Underlying attack: xGI/90 0.08 (xG 0.7, xA 0.2), not just returns (0G 2A).",
       "Five-gameweek value 4.00 (raw model 4.08); next-five fixture difficulty 3.4."
      ],
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Silva, Tavernier); Balanced Plus allows at most 2 per club in the XI. 0.17 xPts (5-GW average) of the projection came from the recent-form tilt, which Balanced Plus removes. Price: Hill £5.6m vs
Muharemović £5.1m (£0.5m cheaper with Balanced Plus). In: Playable bench option: 100% start probability, 100% available. Underlying attack: xGI/90 0.08 (xG 0.7, xA 0.2), not just returns (0G 2A). Five-
gameweek value 4.00 (raw model 4.08); next-five fixture difficulty 3.4."
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       "Secure starter: 100% start probability, ~80 expected minutes.",
       "Underlying attack: xGI/90 0.60 (xG 4.6, xA 1.3), not just returns (4G 1A).",
       "Five-gameweek value 4.43 (raw model 4.30); next-five fixture difficulty 2.8.",
       "Keeps MUN at 1 in the XI (limit 2)."
      ],
      "explanation": "Rudoni (COV, £4.9m, bench in Safe) -> Mbeumo (MUN, £7.9m, XI in Balanced Plus). GW11 xPts 4.47 -> 3.78; five-GW value 3.69 -> 4.43. Out: Lower five-gameweek value: 3.69 vs 4.43
for Mbeumo. Price: Rudoni £4.9m vs Mbeumo £7.9m (£3.0m dearer with Balanced Plus). In: Secure starter: 100% start probability, ~80 expected minutes. Underlying attack: xGI/90 0.60 (xG 4.6, xA 1.3), not
just returns (4G 1A). Five-gameweek value 4.43 (raw model 4.30); next-five fixture difficulty 2.8. Keeps MUN at 1 in the XI (limit 2)."
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    },
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      "to": "XI",
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     },
     {
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      "from": "XI",
      "to": "bench",
      "explanation": "Silva moves from XI to bench. Aggressive started 3 BOU players; Balanced Plus keeps at most 2 in the XI and Silva is not among its top 2 by value for this gameweek. Five-gameweek
value 3.88 ranks below the players Balanced Plus starts."
     }
    ],
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      "whyOut": ["Lower five-gameweek value: 3.36 vs 3.70 for Tzolakis.","Price: A.Becker £5.5m vs Tzolakis £4.7m (£0.8m cheaper with Balanced Plus)."],
      "whyIn": ["Fit substitute keeper: 100% start probability, 100% available.","Five-gameweek value 3.70 (raw model 3.62); next-five fixture difficulty 3.2."],
      "explanation": "A.Becker (LIV, £5.5m, bench in Aggressive) -> Tzolakis (HUL, £4.7m, bench in Balanced Plus). GW11 xPts 3.43 -> 3.58; five-GW value 3.36 -> 3.70. Out: Lower five-gameweek value:
3.36 vs 3.70 for Tzolakis. Price: A.Becker £5.5m vs Tzolakis £4.7m (£0.8m cheaper with Balanced Plus). In: Fit substitute keeper: 100% start probability, 100% available. Five-gameweek value 3.70 (raw
model 3.62); next-five fixture difficulty 3.2."
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       "Lower five-gameweek value: 4.03 vs 4.24 for De Cuyper."
      ],
      "whyIn": [
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       "Underlying attack: xGI/90 0.43 (xG 2.4, xA 1.5), not just returns (2G 4A).",
       "Five-gameweek value 4.24 (raw model 4.26); next-five fixture difficulty 2.8.",
       "Keeps BHA at 2 in the XI (limit 2)."
      ],
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      "explanation": "Hill (BOU, £5.6m, XI in Aggressive) -> De Cuyper (BHA, £5.5m, XI in Balanced Plus). GW11 xPts 4.45 -> 4.10; five-GW value 4.03 -> 4.24. Out: Aggressive started 3 BOU players (Hill, Silva, Tavernier); Balanced Plus allows at most 2 per club in the XI. 0.17 xPts (5-GW average) of the projection came from the recent-form tilt, which Balanced Plus removes. Lower five-gameweek value: 4.03 vs 4.24 for De Cuyper. In: Secure starter: 97% start probability, ~78 expected minutes. Underlying attack: xGI/90 0.43 (xG 2.4, xA 1.5), not just returns (2G 4A). Five-gameweek value 4.24 (raw model 4.26); next-five fixture difficulty 2.8. Keeps BHA at 2 in the XI (limit 2)."
     },
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      "in": {"id":334,"name":"Muharemović","club":"LEE","priceM":5.1,"role":"bench","gw0Xpts":3.8,"fiveGwValue":4},
      "whyOut": ["Lower five-gameweek value: 3.47 vs 4.00 for Muharemović.","Price: Ajer £4.5m vs Muharemović £5.1m (£0.6m dearer with Balanced Plus)."],
      "whyIn": [
       "Playable bench option: 100% start probability, 100% available.",
       "Underlying attack: xGI/90 0.08 (xG 0.7, xA 0.2), not just returns (0G 2A).",
       "Five-gameweek value 4.00 (raw model 4.08); next-five fixture difficulty 3.4."
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      "explanation": "Ajer (BRE, £4.5m, bench in Aggressive) -> Muharemović (LEE, £5.1m, bench in Balanced Plus). GW11 xPts 3.76 -> 3.80; five-GW value 3.47 -> 4.00. Out: Lower five-gameweek value: 3.47 vs 4.00 for Muharemović. Price: Ajer £4.5m vs Muharemović £5.1m (£0.6m dearer with Balanced Plus). In: Playable bench option: 100% start probability, 100% available. Underlying attack: xGI/90 0.08 (xG 0.7, xA 0.2), not just returns (0G 2A). Five-gameweek value 4.00 (raw model 4.08); next-five fixture difficulty 3.4."
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      "whyIn": [
       "Secure starter: 100% start probability, ~80 expected minutes.",
       "Underlying attack: xGI/90 0.60 (xG 4.6, xA 1.3), not just returns (4G 1A).",
       "Five-gameweek value 4.43 (raw model 4.30); next-five fixture difficulty 2.8.",
       "Keeps MUN at 1 in the XI (limit 2)."
      ],
      "explanation": "Rudoni (COV, £4.9m, XI in Aggressive) -> Mbeumo (MUN, £7.9m, XI in Balanced Plus). GW11 xPts 4.47 -> 3.78; five-GW value 3.69 -> 4.43. Out: Lower five-gameweek value: 3.69 vs 4.43 for Mbeumo. Price: Rudoni £4.9m vs Mbeumo £7.9m (£3.0m dearer with Balanced Plus). In: Secure starter: 100% start probability, ~80 expected minutes. Underlying attack: xGI/90 0.60 (xG 4.6, xA 1.3), not just returns (4G 1A). Five-gameweek value 4.43 (raw model 4.30); next-five fixture difficulty 2.8. Keeps MUN at 1 in the XI (limit 2)."
     },
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      "whyOut": ["Lower five-gameweek value: 3.65 vs 4.19 for Ødegaard.","Price: Wirtz £7.2m vs Ødegaard £6.7m (£0.5m cheaper with Balanced Plus)."],
      "whyIn": [
       "Secure starter: 97% start probability, ~78 expected minutes.",
       "Underlying attack: xGI/90 0.53 (xG 2.4, xA 2.5), not just returns (3G 0A).",
       "Five-gameweek value 4.19 (raw model 4.18); next-five fixture difficulty 3.4.",
       "Keeps ARS at 1 in the XI (limit 2)."
      ],
      "explanation": "Wirtz (LIV, £7.2m, XI in Aggressive) -> Ødegaard (ARS, £6.7m, XI in Balanced Plus). GW11 xPts 4.24 -> 4.25; five-GW value 3.65 -> 4.19. Out: Lower five-gameweek value: 3.65 vs 4.19 for Ødegaard. Price: Wirtz £7.2m vs Ødegaard £6.7m (£0.5m cheaper with Balanced Plus). In: Secure starter: 97% start probability, ~78 expected minutes. Underlying attack: xGI/90 0.53 (xG 2.4, xA 2.5), not just returns (3G 0A). Five-gameweek value 4.19 (raw model 4.18); next-five fixture difficulty 3.4. Keeps ARS at 1 in the XI (limit 2)."
     },
     {
      "position": "MID",
      "out": {"id":45,"name":"McGinn","club":"AVL","priceM":5.4,"role":"bench","gw0Xpts":4.21,"fiveGwValue":3.93},
      "in": {"id":124,"name":"Groß","club":"BHA","priceM":6.3,"role":"bench","gw0Xpts":4.15,"fiveGwValue":4.28},
      "whyOut": ["Lower five-gameweek value: 3.93 vs 4.28 for Groß.","Price: McGinn £5.4m vs Groß £6.3m (£0.9m dearer with Balanced Plus)."],
      "whyIn": [
       "Playable bench option: 99% start probability, 100% available.",
       "Underlying attack: xGI/90 0.54 (xG 3.0, xA 2.2), not just returns (4G 6A).",
       "Five-gameweek value 4.28 (raw model 4.36); next-five fixture difficulty 2.8."
      ],
      "explanation": "McGinn (AVL, £5.4m, bench in Aggressive) -> Groß (BHA, £6.3m, bench in Balanced Plus). GW11 xPts 4.21 -> 4.15; five-GW value 3.93 -> 4.28. Out: Lower five-gameweek value: 3.93 vs 4.28 for Groß. Price: McGinn £5.4m vs Groß £6.3m (£0.9m dearer with Balanced Plus). In: Playable bench option: 99% start probability, 100% available. Underlying attack: xGI/90 0.54 (xG 3.0, xA 2.2), not just returns (4G 6A). Five-gameweek value 4.28 (raw model 4.36); next-five fixture difficulty 2.8."
     }
    ],
    "captaincy": {
     "sameCaptain": true,
     "sameVice": true,
     "explanation": "Captain: Aggressive: Haaland (5.52 xPts) | Balanced Plus: Haaland (5.52 xPts): same pick (highest model xPts in the XI). Vice: Aggressive: Isak | Balanced Plus: Isak: same pick."
    },
```

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    "totalChanges": 8
   }
  ],
  "notes": [
   "GW11 xPts = the XI each strategy actually chose + its captain's extra points. GW12 onward use each squad's best XI (unconstrained) so every strategy is measured the same way.",
   "All four strategies use the same FPL data snapshot and the same £100m budget; Balanced, Safe and Aggressive come from the unchanged optimiser."
  ]
 }
}
=== END STRUCTURED DATA ===
```